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The Week in Playback: Furrion Finds New Home, SI Adds Clear Vinyl Shades

https://www.cepro.com/news/the-week-in-playback-furrion-finds-new-home-si-adds-clear-vinyl-shades/627387/

Kanto Living has acquired Furrion, allowing it to expand its outdoor entertainment offerings, which aligns with the growing demand for outdoor TVs. Additionally, Shade Innovations introduced a clear vinyl option for outdoor screens, enhancing aesthetic and functional possibilities in outdoor living spaces. These developments signify a positive trend for integrators in the custom integration market.

Audio Advice Adds Sound Components to Growing Family of National Locations

https://www.cepro.com/news/audio-advice-adds-sound-components-to-growing-family-of-national-locations/627354/

Audio Advice is set to acquire Sound Components, expanding its reach and expertise in the audio and video integration industry. Sound Components will continue its operations in Miami, providing existing services while gaining access to Audio Advice's extensive resources. This merger highlights the ongoing trend of consolidation within the custom integration market.

Airzone Named Savant Recommended Partner

https://www.cepro.com/briefs/airzone-named-savant-recommended-partner/627371/

Airzone has been designated as a Savant Recommended Partner, allowing integrators to access their HVAC solutions through Savant's ecosystem. This partnership aims to simplify the integration of inverter HVAC systems with smart home platforms, enhancing energy-efficient climate control. The Airzone Aidoo Pro facilitates precise communication and control for mini splits and heat pumps, ensuring optimal system performance.

Why Lutron Is All-In on CEDIA Expo 2026

https://www.cepro.com/news/why-lutron-is-all-in-on-cedia-expo-2026/627361/

Lutron's Ed Blair emphasizes the importance of education and industry connections at CEDIA Expo 2026. The company is investing significantly to enhance its presence, with expanded training and product demonstrations. Blair believes that maintaining a strong central gathering like CEDIA Expo is crucial for the future of the custom integration industry.

AVPro Global Announces New Design Services Across AV, Control Portfolio

https://www.cepro.com/news/avpro-global-announces-new-design-services-across-av-control-portfolio/627343/

AVPro Global has launched the AVPro Design Services team to assist integrators across various sectors in designing and implementing their AV systems. This initiative supports a wide range of market segments, ensuring tailored solutions using AVPro's extensive product portfolio. The new team enhances integrators' capabilities, promoting collaboration and expertise in deploying advanced technology solutions.

Kanto Living Acquires Assets for Furrion Outdoor TV Product Line from Lippert

https://www.cepro.com/news/kanto-living-acquires-assets-for-furrion-outdoor-tv-product-line-from-lippert/627341/

Kanto Living has acquired select assets of Furrion's outdoor TV product line from Lippert, enhancing its existing AV portfolio. This strategic move aims to better support AV integrators with a brand already rooted in the audio and video integration space. Kanto plans to ensure continuity and growth of the Furrion product line for outdoor entertainment.

Sharp Debuts New Premium Appliances at KBIS 2026

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/sharp-debuts-new-premium-appliances-at-kbis-2026/

Sharp Home Electronics Company is unveiling over 20 new premium appliances at KBIS 2026, focusing on style, innovation, and Universal Design. Key products include the high-speed Celerity™ oven for faster cooking and new finishes for the iconic Microwave Drawer™. The launch reflects a commitment to meet evolving consumer needs and enhance everyday living.

IWSH Launches Community Plumbing Challenge in L.A.

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/iwsh-launches-community-plumbing-challenge-in-l-a/

The International Water, Sanitation and Hygiene Foundation (IWSH) is launching a Community Plumbing Challenge to upgrade plumbing at the Los Angeles Mission, supporting individuals experiencing homelessness. The project involves skilled volunteer plumbers and aims to improve water efficiency, code compliance, and system durability. IWSH invites industry partners to contribute financially or through in-kind donations to enhance public health and sanitation.

WOODCONCEPT Debuts New Cabinetry at KBIS 2026

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/woodconcept-debuts-new-cabinetry-at-kbis-2026/

WOODCONCEPT will debut its new cabinetry collections at the 2026 Kitchen & Bath Industry Show in Orlando, featuring innovative door styles and finish options. CEO Kevin Wang expressed excitement about connecting with industry professionals and showcasing their commitment to quality craftsmanship. Visitors can explore partnership opportunities and discover the latest offerings at Booth #S19143.

Cambria Unveils ‘Style Without Limits’ at KBIS 2026

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/cambria-unveils-style-without-limits-at-kbis-2026/

At KBIS 2026, Cambria launched its 'Style Without Limits' exhibit, showcasing quartz surfaces beyond countertops to walls and floors with innovative designs. The booth features new designs like St. Isley and Traymore Bay, paired with luxury cabinetry and fixtures. Executive VP Summer Kath will discuss kitchen and bath trends at the International Builders’ Show.

New VIATERA Quartz Colors Launch at KBIS 2026

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/new-viatera-quartz-colors-launch-at-kbis-2026/

At KBIS 2026, LX Hausys America announced the launch of six new VIATERA quartz colors, featuring advanced technologies like TrueView and NeoQ for enhanced aesthetics and sustainability. These colors reflect modern design trends, while being compliant with the BABA Act for federally funded projects. LX Hausys' commitment to U.S.-based manufacturing underscores their sustainability goals and product quality.

LX Hausys Debuts Four New HIMACS Colors at KBIS 2026

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/lx-hausys-debuts-four-new-himacs-colors-at-kbis-2026/

LX Hausys unveiled four new HIMACS solid surface colors at KBIS 2026, designed for both commercial and residential use. These colors, including two from the Calacatta collection and two from the Terrazzo collection, combine durability with sophisticated aesthetics. The new offerings aim to meet the evolving design needs of interior spaces, providing versatility and natural inspiration.

LX Hausys Debuts BORTE Premium Panel System at KBIS

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/lx-hausys-debuts-borte-premium-panel-system-at-kbis/

LX Hausys America Inc. has introduced the BORTE Premium Panel System at KBIS 2026, featuring innovative design and advanced technology for enhanced residential and commercial spaces. The system includes three collections, each with unique colors and textures designed to elevate interiors seamlessly. BORTE panels are certified for low emissions and sustainability, offering durability and easy maintenance.

True Caliber Reveals 2026 Color of the Year: Espresso

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/true-caliber-reveals-2026-color-of-the-year-espresso/

True Caliber has unveiled its 2026 Color of the Year: Espresso, a rich brown finish designed to enhance both modern and traditional spaces. This color adds warmth and balance, creating an inviting atmosphere in kitchens and outdoor areas. The new hue is part of True Caliber's customizable options, allowing for 96 unique color combinations.

Nice Expands U.S. Representation with Thomasson Marketing Group

https://www.securitysales.com/news/nice-representation-thomasson-marketing-group/619335/

Nice has partnered with Thomasson Marketing Group to enhance dealer support for its 2GIG security solutions across the Pacific Western United States. This collaboration aims to provide local dealers with additional resources and expertise, reinforcing Nice's commitment to market development. The partnership will cover various states including California, Arizona, and Colorado, helping to grow dealer engagement.

IQSIGHT Appoints Wilkinson as Vice President of Sales, North America

https://www.securitysales.com/news/iqsight-wilkinson-vice-president-sales-north-america/619317/

IQSIGHT has appointed Ted Wilkinson as Vice President of Sales for North America, aiming to enhance sales growth and strengthen relationships with channel partners. With over three decades of experience, Wilkinson is expected to execute a regional strategy that aligns with IQSIGHT's global goals. He emphasizes delivering exceptional customer experiences while leveraging the company's strengths in visual intelligence.

Lessing Gold, Partner, Mitchell Silberberg & Knupp: Best Advice

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/lessing-gold-mitchell-silberberg-knupp-best-advice/619305/

Lessing Gold emphasizes the importance of humor and honesty in the security industry. He advises newcomers to be straightforward with customers and not to accept jobs beyond their expertise. He also highlights Peter Raymond as a pivotal figure to listen to for industry insights.

Why Early Access Planning Is Now Mission-Critical at Data Centers

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/why-early-access-planning-is-now-mission-critical-at-data-centers/619295/

The article emphasizes the necessity of integrating physical security and access control early in the design process of data centers to enhance efficiency and reduce risks. It highlights the shift towards standardized designs and digital tools to streamline project execution. Ultimately, fostering collaboration among stakeholders is crucial for successful outcomes in mission-critical environments.

ZeroEyes Partners with Academic Innovators to Help Universities

https://www.securitysales.com/news/zeroeyes-partners-academic-innovators-universities-security/619289/

ZeroEyes has partnered with Academic Innovators to bolster security and emergency response in higher education systems. This collaboration combines ZeroEyes' advanced threat detection technologies with the multidisciplinary expertise of Academic Innovators. Together, they aim to enhance campus safety and help institutions navigate complex challenges.

SIA Welcomes New Chairman of Data Privacy Advisory Board

https://www.securitysales.com/news/sia-tony-manna-chairman-data-privacy-advisory-board/619277/

Tony Manna has been appointed as the chair of the SIA Data Privacy Advisory Board, focusing on best practices for data protection. He brings extensive legal and privacy expertise from his role at Allegion, where he advises on cybersecurity and legal matters. Manna aims to strengthen resources for managing privacy risks amid evolving regulations and security challenges.

Freddy Kuo, Chairman, Luminys Systems Corp.: Best Advice

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/freddy-kuo-chairman-luminys-best-security-advice/619271/

Freddy Kuo, chairman of Luminys Systems Corp., emphasizes the importance of understanding customer problems before presenting solutions in the security industry. He advises newcomers to learn the entire ecosystem and spend time at job sites to understand real-world challenges. Kuo highlights the value of listening to experienced industry professionals, particularly Wayne Hurd, to build trust and

create effective security solutions.

Emergency24, Worldview Monitoring Ink Partnership

https://www.securitysales.com/news/emergency24-worldview-monitoring-ink-partnership/619266/

Emergency24 and Worldview Monitoring have formed a strategic partnership to meet the rising demand for remote guarding services in the U.S. This collaboration combines Emergency24's monitoring infrastructure with Worldview's expertise in remote guarding. The aim is to help dealers and security providers enhance service offerings while ensuring operational consistency.

Commercial Security Made Easy with Wireless Locks from ProdataKey (PDK)

https://www.securitysales.com/sponsored/commercial-security-made-easy-with-wireless-locks-from-prodatakey-pdk/619261/

ProdataKey has launched the Red™ Wireless Cylindrical Lock, designed for modern commercial security needs. This lock offers easy installation, flexible management via a cloud platform, and enhanced access control capabilities. It provides a cost-effective solution to meet the evolving security requirements of various commercial environments.

Pye-Barker Acquires Washington-Based Fire Protection Specialists

https://www.securitysales.com/news/pye-barker-acquires-fire-protection-specialists/619250/

Pye-Barker Fire & Safety has acquired Fire Protection Specialists in Washington, enhancing its fire protection services in the Pacific Northwest. This acquisition adds capabilities such as advanced system monitoring and fire extinguisher service to Pye-Barker's existing offerings. The integration aims to improve customer service in the region as both teams join forces.

The Monitoring Association Elects 2026-2028 Board of Directors

https://www.securitysales.com/news/the-monitoring-association-elects-2026-2028-board-of-directors/619224/

The Monitoring Association has elected seven industry leaders to its board of directors for the 2026-2028 term. These leaders will leverage their expertise to guide initiatives that enhance public safety and industry standards. Their terms will commence after the Annual Meeting in November 2026.

SIA Appoints Jasvir Gill as Vice Chairman of Utilities Advisory Board

https://www.securitysales.com/news/sia-jasvir-gill-vice-chairman-utilities-advisory-board/619216/

The Security Industry Association has appointed Dr. Jasvir Gill as the new vice chairman of the Utilities Advisory Board, where he aims to lead discussions on cybersecurity in the utilities sector. With over two decades of experience in enterprise security, Gill emphasizes reimagining security as a means for resilience and sustainable growth. His leadership is expected to significantly influence how security professionals address the challenges of protecting critical infrastructure.

How to Find Integration Partners Who Will Drive Long-Term Growth

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/how-to-find-integration-partners-drive-long-term-growth/619211/

Effective integration partnerships are crucial for growth in the security sector, promoting marketing streams and market exposure. Successful collaborations involve established rules, joint sales motions, and a long-term commitment. With proper assessment, integrators can avoid poor partnerships and enhance customer value.

Sombra Shades Expands U.S. Presence with New Headquarters, Warehouse and Technology Training Facility in Texas

https://www.wf-vision.com/industry-news/sombra-shades-expands-u-s-presence-with-new-headquarters-warehouse-and-technology-training-facility-in-texas/

Sombra Shades has expanded its U.S. operations by opening a new headquarters, warehouse, and technology training facility in Carrollton, Texas. This advancement is part of the company's growth strategy, providing improved training and service capabilities. The facility will enhance dealer support with both in-person and virtual educational opportunities.

From Shade to Sustainability: Inside Yardzen's 2026 Trend Report

https://www.wf-vision.com/outdoor-living/from-shade-to-sustainability-inside-yardzens-2026-trend-report/

Yardzen's 2026 Trend Report highlights significant shifts in outdoor living design, focusing on comfort, sustainability, and privacy. Homeowners seek functional outdoor spaces that blend indoor and outdoor living, with features like shade structures and low-maintenance landscapes. The report emphasizes a growing preference for intimate, personalized outdoor environments over traditional entertaining areas.

Hartmann&Forbes; Named One of Oregon's Best Green Workplaces

https://www.wf-vision.com/industry-news/hartmannforbes-named-one-of-oregons-best-green-workplaces/

Hartmann&Forbes; has been named one of Oregon's 100 Best Green Workplaces, securing the No. 4 spot in 2026, marking its 14th consecutive year on the list. The company's commitment to sustainability is evident in its handcrafted window coverings made from renewable natural fibers. Founder Michael Jones emphasizes the importance of teamwork and continuous improvement in achieving lasting environmental responsibility.

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Origin Acoustics Launches Built-to-Order Soundbars for Custom Residential Projects

https://www.cepro.com/news/origin-acoustics-launches-built-to-order-soundbars-for-custom-residential-projects/627386/

Origin Acoustics has launched a Built-to-Order Soundbar program tailored for custom residential projects, allowing integrators to specify lengths and configurations. The soundbars are adaptable for indoor and outdoor usage, featuring customizable audio technologies. This initiative aims to meet the demands of luxury clients who seek harmonious integration of technology within their home's design.

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U.S. Consumer Discretionary Spending Bifurcates

https://www.cepro.com/news/u-s-consumer-discretionary-spending-bifurcates/627381/

U.S. consumer discretionary spending shows a split trend with many pulling back on non-essentials while others seek value-oriented options. A recent report reveals that 39% have reduced spending, but 31% have increased it, highlighting a divergence in financial confidence. Younger consumers are more inclined to embrace AI for price comparisons and second-hand purchases.

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Coordinating Decorative Lighting in the Connected Home (without Ruining Your Design)

https://www.cepro.com/news/how-to-coordinate-decorative-lighting-in-the-connected-home-without-ruining-your-design/627376/

Integrating decorative lighting with architectural designs requires careful management of color and control systems. A balance between decorative fixtures and controllable lights is crucial for optimal lighting results. By layering lighting and creating adaptable scenes, even static decorative lights can enhance ambiance without compromising design.

The New SI KAOS Vinyl Lets the Sun in without the Rest of the Outdoors

https://www.cepro.com/news/the-new-si-kaos-vinyl-lets-the-sun-in-without-the-rest-of-the-outdoors/627349/

Shade Innovations has introduced the KAOS VINYL outdoor shades, which combine clear vinyl and a motorized platform for enhanced outdoor views. The shades are designed to withstand extreme temperatures and are easy to maintain, making them suitable for various installations. This product enhances outdoor spaces while providing durability and weather protection.

Empava Debuts Smart WiFi Cold Plunge Tub for Home

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/empava-debuts-smart-wifi-cold-plunge-tub-for-home/

Empava has launched a Smart WiFi Indoor/Outdoor Cold Plunge Tub, designed for at-home cold therapy with a rapid cooling capability from 86°F to 37°F. The tub features an all-in-one design, smart WiFi control for temperature adjustments, and enhanced safety with dual drains. This product caters to the growing demand for residential wellness solutions, allowing users to integrate professional-grade recovery into their homes.

Sharp Unveils Stylish Compact Kitchen Appliances

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/sharp-unveils-stylish-compact-kitchen-appliances/

Sharp introduces a new line of stylish compact kitchen appliances designed for small spaces, including a 24" Counter-Depth French Door Refrigerator and a Wall Oven. With over 20 products debuting at KBIS 2026, Sharp aims to address common frustrations in kitchen functionality and design. Their commitment to innovation and design is reflected in appliances that combine technology with aesthetic appeal.

How Integrators Help Customers Go from Surveillance to Prevention

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/security-integrators-from-surveillance-to-prevention/619282/

Security integrators are evolving from providing surveillance solutions to promoting prevention strategies. As detection technologies advance, clients increasingly seek ways to prevent incidents before they occur rather than merely documenting them. This shift creates opportunities for integrators to become trusted advisors, enhancing security outcomes through coordinated response strategies.

Integrators Need to Rethink Their Approach to School Security

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/integrators-need-to-rethink-their-approach-to-school-security/619242/

Schools are shifting their focus on security from just hardware like cameras to a comprehensive approach that emphasizes prevention and intervention. The integration of AI is changing expectations, as districts seek technology that helps identify risks early and supports decision-making without overwhelming staff. Future security strategies will prioritize collaboration and transparency while enhancing situational awareness for better campus safety.

FieldResolve Expands Knowledge Base to 40,000+ Documents

https://www.securitysales.com/news/fieldresolve-40000-documents-36-manufacturers/619237/

FieldResolve, an AI-powered field support platform by The CMOOR Group, now features over 40,000 documents from 36 manufacturers, enhancing its technical knowledge base for security professionals. This milestone allows technicians to troubleshoot multi-manufacturer environments more effectively, providing quick and precise answers. With a focus on data privacy, FieldResolve ensures that technician queries remain secure and is designed for real-world installation complexities.

Sunbrella Introduces Marx Outdoor Drapery

https://www.wf-vision.com/industry-news/sunbrella-introduces-marx-outdoor-drapery/

Sunbrella has launched the Marx outdoor drapery, blending indoor elegance with outdoor durability. Featuring a fine basketweave texture, it's designed to filter sunlight while enhancing outdoor spaces. The drapery is available in eight fade-resistant colors and is machine washable for easy maintenance.

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Shark Attack Near Fla. Naval Base: Surveillance Videos of the Week

https://www.securitysales.com/news/shark-attack-florida-naval-base-surveillance-videos-week/619323/

The latest surveillance videos showcase a shark attack near a Florida naval base and other viral incidents including an alligator assisting police and Knicks fans celebrating their NBA Finals comeback. Among other notable footage are a Massachusetts mother disrupting a graduation and flash floods in the Midwest. This diverse collection highlights how animals and unexpected events dominate news reels globally.

World Fire Congress Advances Global Fire Service Collaboration

https://www.securitysales.com/news/world-fire-congress-global-fire-service-collaboration-new-research-framework/619312/

The World Fire Congress has appointed the Metropolitan Fire Chiefs Association to serve as its Secretariat, fostering global collaboration in fire and emergency services. This structure aims to enhance continuity and long-term engagement across international challenges in fire safety. The next Congress will be held in London, with Dubai hosting in 2028.

Rescuers Save 8 in Flooded Cave: Surveillance Videos of the Week

https://www.securitysales.com/news/rescuers-save-8-flooded-cave-surveillance-videos-week/619227/

Eight cave explorers in Laos had to be rescued after a flood trapped them, highlighting a dramatic surveillance video of the week. Additional stories included sonic booms and explosions that captured significant attention across the U.S. This week's unusual events made for a captivating collection of surveillance footage.

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Full Cleaned Articles

Cepro

The Week in Playback: Furrion Finds New Home, SI Adds Clear Vinyl Shades

https://www.cepro.com/news/the-week-in-playback-furrion-finds-new-home-si-adds-clear-vinyl-shades/627387/

The Week in Playback: Furrion Finds New Home, SI Adds Clear Vinyl Shades

Peel back the noise of the news week with a relaxing spin through some of custom integration's biggest developments.

Published: June 28, 2026Nick Boever

Kanto Living Acquires Furrion from Lippert

Summer’s in full swing, and that means people are looking for outdoor TVs en masse. Which mean’s it’s also a perfect time for outdoor living brands to reassess and grow out their portfolios. At least, that’s what I like to imagine was what prompted the recent purchase of Furrion’s assets by Kanto Living.

Longtime residents of the CI channel have likely heard of Kanto by this point, with the company being already tapped into the AV product sphere through manufacturing products like speakers, TV mounts and other AV accessories. Furrion, too, is likely a familiar name, as the company manufactures outdoor TVs, a product category that has seen increasing interest from the client’s side over the years.

In my opinion, it’s a purchase that makes complete and total sense, and others in the industry seem to hold that sentiment as well. As Robb Stott, Editor-in-Chief over at Connected Design noted when talking about Lippert’s original acquisition of Furrion back in 2021:

“It just didn’t seem to fit alongside the heating and cooling, kitchen, and camera/observation systems. Instead, it felt like something someone inside the company got excited about and wanted for their own RV setup, so they brought it within the fold of the larger company.”

The fact that an AV company (especially one that is already doing business in the channel) is getting its hands on the Furrion line should be nothing but good news for integrators. I don’t intend for this to sound like Lippert was a poor partner for integrators; instead, I mean to say that, by comparison, Kanto is going to be a little bit tapped into the specific business needs and challenges of the AV industry than Lippert was.

That’s not to mention how the Furrion acquisition pairs with everything else Kanto already offers. Outdoor TVs like Furrion typically require mounts (of which Kanto already has many on offer) and discerning clients generally like to listen to their TV audio through a set of dedicated speakers (which Kanto also offers). The ecosystem is interconnected, but not siloed, a critical distinction for any manufacturer in this industry.

Kanto in this exchange gains the ability to offer a nice, complete outdoor entertainment package, while Lippert can now really start to focus on building themselves up as an outdoor lifestyle brand.

Funnily enough, I feel like Lippert being able to do that is a secret boon for integrators, as the crossover between clients able to afford a luxury home as well as a kick-ass glamping set-up must be about as frequent as those who own yachts. Maybe integrators won't be working directly with Lippert anymore, but that added focus can only mean good things for the market.

SI Introduces KAOS Vinyl Product

Being able to use an outdoor enclosure year-round (especially if you're a resident of the North) is a particular luxury, though the one thing that I always lamented was the fact that, as things get cold and the screens come down, you still lose one of the main draws of the space: feeling as though you're immersed in the natural environment. My guess is that Shade Innovations (SI) felt the same way.

The company revealed its new KAOS Vinyl product this week, which adds a new clear vinyl screen option to its KAOS platform, reopening the window (in a very figurative sense) to the outdoors by making its screens see-through. The vinyl itself can reportedly survive a temperature range of 120F to -10 Degrees without fogging, cracking or shrinking and comes available in sizes up to 24 feet wide.

Like the Kanto deal, it's another move that makes an incredible amount of sense. So much so that it got me wondering: is this the first time we've gotten a clear vinyl offering for outdoor screens in the CI channel? After doing a bit of research, that does seem to be the case here.

Yes, residential motorized screen manufacturers have offered various types of mesh or fabric options over the years. But I couldn't find any evidence of a clear vinyl option being available before this one from SI.

Origin Acoustics Launches Built-to-Order Soundbars for Custom Residential Projects

https://www.cepro.com/news/origin-acoustics-launches-built-to-order-soundbars-for-custom-residential-projects/627386/

Origin Acoustics Launches Built-to-Order Soundbars for Custom Residential Projects

Origin Acoustics has launched a Built-to-Order Soundbar program that allows custom integrators to specify soundbars tailored to each residential project with custom sizing, configurations and mounting options.

Published: June 26, 2026Zachary Comeau

Image/Origin Acoustics

Key Takeaways

- Origin Acoustics has introduced a Built-to-Order Soundbar program that enables dealers to specify custom-length soundbars for residential installations.

- The soundbars can be configured for indoor or outdoor use with customizable channel layouts, mounting options, IR spacing and audio technologies.

- The offering is designed to help integrators match audio systems to larger displays and architecturally driven residential projects without relying on standard-sized soundbars.

Origin Acoustics has introduced a new Built-to-Order Soundbar program that allows custom integrators to specify soundbars tailored to the requirements of individual residential projects, including custom lengths, channel configurations and mounting options.

Manufactured at the company's Las Vegas facility, the soundbars are designed to accommodate a range of display sizes and installation environments, including both indoor and outdoor applications. According to Origin Acoustics, integrators can specify custom lengths, IR spacing, multiple channel configurations and flexible mounting options to better match project requirements.

The soundbars are also available with either the company's Ambisonic or DPSD technologies, allowing dealers to select an audio solution based on the performance needs of each installation.

The introduction comes as larger displays, custom millwork and architecturally integrated technology continue to shape luxury residential projects, where standard-sized soundbars may not align with the proportions or design of a space.

"Luxury clients expect technology to be as intentional as every other design decision in the home," said Nick Berry, CEO of Origin Acoustics, in the announcement. "Our dealers are collaborating with architects, interior designers, and builders earlier in the design process than ever before. As those projects become more customized, manufacturers have to deliver solutions that adapt to the project – not ask the project to adapt to the product."

Origin Acoustics says the offering is intended to help integrators specify audio solutions that complement both the architectural design and performance goals of a project, whether for media rooms, great rooms or outdoor entertainment spaces.

"The best technology disappears into the design," said Robyn Travaglia, in-house architectural designer at Origin Acoustics. "When we work alongside architects, designers, and integrators, the goal is to preserve the integrity of the space while ensuring the listening experience lives up to the expectations of a luxury home."

The Built-to-Order Soundbar program is available exclusively through authorized Origin Acoustics dealers.

Catch Origin Acoustics at CEDIA Expo 2026 at Booth #2523.

U.S. Consumer Discretionary Spending Bifurcates

https://www.cepro.com/news/u-s-consumer-discretionary-spending-bifurcates/627381/

U.S. Consumer Discretionary Spending Bifurcates

Nearly as many consumers say they're pulling back on non-essential purchases as are ramping up purchases with value-hunting holding sway over all walks of life.

Published: June 26, 2026Nick Boever

U.S. consumers keep spending, but growing differences in financial confidence are helping to shape those habits as those with dwindling views on their own positions continue to seek out value-oriented options, if they're not slashing discretionary spending budgets entirely.

Where the data comes from

The findings stem from a recent report by ESW, an enterprise e-commerce platform, looking at the spending behaviors of roughly 24,000 U.S. consumers.

Discretionary spending among U.S. consumers continues to be split

The survey found that 39% of U.S. consumers say discretionary spending (the spending typically tied to home renovations) has decreased over the past year. However, keeping in line with the K-shaped economy that has taken root, 31% say it has increased with the remainder reporting no change.

Of course, that doesn't mean consumers are still going with the luxury option. When breaking down respondent buying patterns in terms of "financial confidence," the study found that 50% of those who feel unconfident about their household finances said they were trading down to cheaper options when considering purchases. For comparison, 14% of financially confident buyers still said they were looking for more value buys than before.

This varies across regions, though. Consumers in the West were less likely to trade down to a cheaper option (19%) while those in the Midwest and South were more likely to be bargain hunting on new purchases (26%).

Consumers favor AI for price comparisons and deal-finding

While most respondents (76%) say they're still uneasy about AI-powered payments, 47% of consumers are open to AI-led price comparisons while 44% favor it for finding deals.

Unfortunately, one metric that might better apply to how consumers might evaluate integrators on the web is absent here, and that's AI-powered business assessments using available online reviews and discussion.

Still, one can assume that if consumers are more willing to use AI for price comparisons, then business assessments based on available services, testimonials and reported expenses are not off the table, especially among younger generations who are more willing to use AI as part of the buying process.

Digging deeper: recommerce on the rise?

An interesting wrinkle within the data set is on the topic of second-hand items. Out of all generations, it's the younger crowd pursuing these options, with 25% of Gen-Z consumers favoring second-hand products, not for the sustainability of it all, but for the affordability.

Another interesting data point comes in the form of payment methods. Cards are still king with PayPal consistently ranking second among consumers. However, Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services are on the rise in the U.S. One in five consumers have used such a service in the last year, rising to a 31% usage rate among Millennials.

Integrator takeaways

Does this mean integrators may need to start accepting BNPL payments one day in the not-so-distant-future? Unlikely given the clientele. Though we would be interested in seeing if there's any potential in selling refurbished, high-end AV gear to clients who are avid video/audiophiles but lack the budget to shell out for some equipment fresh out the box.

Really, the data reveals more of the same when it comes to the haves and the have-nots. There seems to be just as many consumers scaling back spending as there are those ramping up purchases. For the editors at CE Pro, we see three things worth keeping in mind as an integrator:

1. Buyers out West seem less concerned with bargain hunting than those in the Midwest and South.

2. Potential buyers are more open to using AI for comparisons and assessments that

3. The younger crowd is increasingly favoring second-hand products for affordability reasons.

Coordinating Decorative Lighting in the Connected Home (without Ruining Your Design)

https://www.cepro.com/news/how-to-coordinate-decorative-lighting-in-the-connected-home-without-ruining-your-design/627376/

Coordinating Decorative Lighting in the Connected Home (without Ruining Your Design)

According to David Warfel, managing color and control for decorative fixtures is key to achieving better lighting results when added to an architectural design plan.

While color compatibility is a recurring issue on many projects featuring decorative and color-tunable lighting side-by-side, that 4000K chandelier in the great room doesn't need to throw your dreams of circadian lighting, warm evening scenes and colorful parties out the window.

Imagine this: you crafted a fantastic architectural lighting design, the client is excited about tunable white recessed downlights and full dynamic color linear lighting and then you find out that the decorative fixtures they want included are set to a static color that cannot be changed by the control system you have in place.

Now it seems like your showstopper of a house going to hit a sour note every time your client keys in a particular lighting scene.

Smart bulbs can solve a few of the problems, but the decorative fixture that can successfully hide an ugly light bulb is increasingly rare. It seems that most of the design trends these days focus on built-in LEDs in countless configurations from twisted knots to glowing surfaces, without a screw-in base in sight.

So, what are you to do as an integrator?

First of all, make sure the fixture is dimmed one way or the other. It can take effort to track down driver specifics for decorative fixtures, but getting the right dimming tech is key to most of the following solutions.

Keep an eye out for 0-10v control, which requires a separate pair of wires to the fixture and likely specific modules added to the controls. 0-10v is ubiquitous in the commercial and hospitality market, so

they will be around for a long time. You can even make the decorative fixtures part of a digital solution by installing in-ceiling DMX dimmers, so long as you took the time to run control signals.

Whatever you do, just make sure the fixtures can dim reasonably low. Don't expect terrific dimming, however, and map out when the fixture starts to flicker or drop out so you keep away from those parts of the dimming curve.

Next, make sure you have plenty of reinforcement utilizing architectural fixtures. A beautiful pendant over a dining room table is a great start, but start with the idea that the table should be well-lit even when the pendant is turned off.

That often means adding layers of light to replace the decorative fixtures, which can seem excessive to a customer. "Why do I need downlights over the table? I have a chandelier!" Study the chandelier and you are likely to discover that it does not put much light down on the table and let the client know.

There is a reason we call them decorative fixtures – they are more decoration than functional light sources. A pair of recessed downlights – with your preferred color technology built in – will almost always deliver more light to the table than a chandelier.

The final key is to build strong scenes first with the lights you can control, then add in the decorative fixtures towards the end.

The scenes need to be easy to access (engraved keypads, for example) and reflect the way the client will live in the space. Stay away from load-based keypads (buttons for chandelier, sconce, downlight, etc.), which will almost inevitably ensure the lighting looks not-so-great every night.

Focus on the most critical areas in a room, perhaps the dining table, kitchen counters, or fireplace, and get the light just right using your high-tech fixtures that feature color tuning, dynamic color, or warm-dimming LEDs. I like to start with lower intensities and then build as necessary–our eyes adjust to ambient brightness and if we start bright everything else will look dark.

Next, light up the secondary features like art and cabinet faces (which might be just about as important and therefore just about as bright), again relying solely on the lights you can control best.

Once you have the light in the room near perfect, only then is it time to start easing in the decorative fixtures.

Audio Advice Adds Sound Components to Growing Family of National Locations

https://www.cepro.com/news/audio-advice-adds-sound-components-to-growing-family-of-national-locations/627354/

Audio Advice Adds Sound Components to Growing Family of National Locations

Founded in 1974, Sound Components has been operating a dual integration and retail business out of Miami, Fla.

From left to right: Bill Petters, President of Sound Components with Scott Newnam, CEO of Audio Advice. Photo courtesy of Audio Advice

Audio Advice keeps on expanding its footprint, announcing that the Raleigh, N.C.-based AV retailer and custom integrator will be acquiring Miami, Fla.-based Sound Components. The movie combines two of the biggest names in the industry, further growing the expertise and reach of Audio Advice across the U.S.

In a statement regarding the acquisition, Bill Petters, President of Sound Components cited Audio Advice's extensive resources and access to additional product lines as two of the main draws for his decision to join businesses.

"I've known the Audio Advice team for decades. Their national reputation, customer service, software systems and worldwide YouTube, social media, and website following are best in class," said Petters.

In a separate statement, Scott Newnam, CEO, of Audio Advice welcomed Sound Components to the Audio Advice team, expressing what he saw as a bright future for the company post-acquisition.

"I've admired Bill and the team at Sound Components since I met them nearly two decades ago," said Newnam. "Our shared value of excellence and passion for delivering happiness make this a natural partnership. Together, we will continue to raise the bar for what customers can expect from an audio, video, and automation company."

The same statement said that Sound Components will continue operating from its South Miami location, with its current team providing the same level of service and expertise. Customers of Sound Components will gain access to Audio Advice's nationwide team, award-winning online resources, design tools and expanded product lines.

Audio Advice, founded in 1978, has been on a tear recently, buying up multiple retail and integrator locations as it continues to expand its national network. Within the past two years, the company has acquired three separate firms in the form of Sound Components, The Sound Room and The Audio Lab.

That's no surprise in the custom integration (CI) channel as M&A; has been the name of the game, picking up speed in 2024, and continuing on through the present day as national integration firms like Daisy have turned up the heat, adopting a very bullish stance on the economic prospects of a nation-spanning integration service.

One concern that lingers in the back of mind for everyone post-merger, however, is how service can change with the expectation being that the bigger a company gets, the less personal the service can be: a big issue when it comes to CI.

Audio Advice has seemingly taken this into consideration with each acquisition. Each addition to the Audio Advice team follows a similar pattern: businesses that have experience in retail and integration, a multidecade-proven business model (Sound Components was founded back in 1974) and are allowed to run independently post-acquisition.

In speaking on its Sound Components acquisition, Audio Advice states it wants to allow both it and Sound Components to "leverage their combined strengths to bring the latest innovations in home entertainment, smart home automation, and commercial AV solutions to an even broader audience."

Airzone Named Savant Recommended Partner

https://www.cepro.com/briefs/airzone-named-savant-recommended-partner/627371/

Airzone Named Savant Recommended Partner

Savant authorized integrators gain streamlined access to inverter HVAC control within the Savant ecosystem.

Published: June 24, 2026Nick Boever

Image courtesy of Airzone

Airzone has announced that it has been named a Savant Recommended Partner, with Airzone Aidoo Pro now available for integrators to purchase through the Savant Store.

As a Savant Recommended Partner, integrators can now source Airzone solutions as part of Savant's streamlined procurement and support ecosystem. This aims to simplify specification, ordering and deployment, while ensuring compatibility with Savant's smart home and power solutions and bolstering integrators' ability to deliver sophisticated, energy-efficient climate control as a core component of the modern smart home.

As of today, the Savant Store will carry Airzone Aidoo Pro

Why integrators should take note

Inverter HVAC units, such as mini splits and heat pumps, have traditionally been difficult to integrate into third-party control platforms. The Airzone Aidoo Pro, however, works as an interface module that bridges the communication gap between inverter HVAC systems and smart home automation platforms with Airzone's proprietary library of manufacturer communication protocols allowing precise control of key system parameters such as mode, setpoint temperature, and fan speed, ensuring accurate system operation and preserving the performance of the HVAC unit.

Posted In: Briefs

Tagged With: AirZone, Control, HVAC, Integrations, Inverter HVACs, Savant, Smart Homes

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Why Lutron Is All-In on CEDIA Expo 2026

https://www.cepro.com/news/why-lutron-is-all-in-on-cedia-expo-2026/627361/

Why Lutron Is All-In on CEDIA Expo 2026

Lutron's Ed Blair discusses the company's expanded commitment to CEDIA Expo 2026 and why education, hands-on experiences, and industry connections remain critical to the custom integration channel.

Published: June 24, 2026Zachary Comeau

For Ed Blair, it's difficult to point to a single favorite memory from CEDIA Expo.

After attending the event for decades, the Lutron president and vice chairman says the memories tend to blur together: celebrating the retirement of longtime colleagues, reconnecting with customers he's known for years and watching the custom integration industry evolve alongside the show itself.

“There’s so many memories,” Blair said during a recent interview with CE Pro, but one stands out.

In the wake of the supply chain disruptions that followed the COVID-19 pandemic, Lutron found itself facing challenges unlike any in its history. Like many manufacturers, the company struggled to secure parts and fulfill orders, leaving customers frustrated and projects delayed.

Rather than avoid the issue, Blair used a CEDIA Expo keynote to address it head-on.

“Without any notes, I had the chance to stand up there and tell our customers the truth, tell them what we were doing about it, and be very honest with them,” he said.

The positive response from dealers reinforced something Blair says has always made CEDIA Expo valuable: the relationships that exist between manufacturers and the integration community.

“It really taught me a lot about the commitment we get from our customers,**what they think about us and how it’s important to be really open and transparent with them,” Blair said.

That relationship is one reason Lutron is increasing its investment in CEDIA Expo 2026, expanding its training opportunities, bringing nearly 100 employees to the show and encouraging the industry to continue supporting what Blair sees as a critical gathering point for manufacturers, integrators and design professionals alike.

A 35-Year Commitment

When Lutron returns to Denver in September, it will be the company’s 35th year exhibiting at the industry’s largest U.S. tradeshow as CEDIA members. That consistency reflects the company’s long-term view of both the custom integration channel, and the role industry events play in supporting it.

“For Lutron, the custom integrator channel is super strategic,” Blair explains. “The ability of that channel to take the products and technology Lutron makes and bring them to life for our end customers is very important to our future.”

According to Blair, CEDIA Expo provides a combination of education, networking and product experiences that is difficult to replicate elsewhere.

“CEDIA Expo is the one place that brings together the right people _and_ the right environments — the show floor, the educational sessions, the events — all the spaces that make real connections possible,” he says.

More Than a Trade Show

For Lutron, those connections extend well beyond sales conversations. Blair says the company views the event as an opportunity for employees across departments to engage directly with customers and better understand the challenges integrators face in the field.

Those interactions are one reason the company plans to increase the number of employees it brings to Denver this year, including trainers, engineers, sales personnel and marketing staff. The company is also expanding its educational efforts at the event with more training sessions.

“We’re doubling our number of training sessions,” Blair says, adding that Lutron will continue offering its hands-on Lutron Lab, which allows attendees to interact with new products and technologies and the

engineers who develop them.

Education, Product Launches and Connections

For Blair, the value of Expo goes beyond product launches.

“It’s the combination of education, launching new products, and connecting with people,” Blair says.

Lutron also sees the show as a way for integrators to strengthen relationships throughout the organization.

“Those kinds of connections you just don’t get on a Teams call,” Blair says.

The company expects its expanded presence to create more opportunities for dealers to interact directly with Lutron trainers, engineers and executives.

Why Lutron Is Investing More This Year

Lutron’s increased commitment comes as some manufacturers have reduced their presence at trade shows or shifted resources to regional events.

The New SI KAOS Vinyl Lets the Sun in without the Rest of the Outdoors

https://www.cepro.com/news/the-new-si-kaos-vinyl-lets-the-sun-in-without-the-rest-of-the-outdoors/627349/

The New SI KAOS Vinyl Lets the Sun in without the Rest of the Outdoors

The new clear vinyl finish option opens a figurative window to the outdoors for any space that likes to leverage outdoor shades for insulation or protection.

Published: June 23, 2026Nick Boever

Shade Innovations has a new update to its KAOS line of outdoor shades with the introduction of KAOS VINYL. According to the company, this new version of the KAOS product combines clear vinyl with the company’s motorized shading platform to create enclosures that not only protect against the elements, but do so while letting occupants still enjoy the scenery.

More information about the new KAOS VINYL

According to SI the KAOS VINYL shades are available in sizes up to 24 feet wide with installation options coming in ceiling, wall or pocket mounts. For control options, dealers have the SI Ecosystem and Bond Bridge Pro to choose from.

The vinyl itself can reportedly survive a temperature range of 120F to -10 Degrees without fogging, cracking or shrinking. Using the included Vinyl Protective Cleaner, SI also touts it as being easy to clean and maintain. SI also notes that the VINYL should resist yellowing, hazing and clouding over time.

Why integrators should take note

KAOS is a shading platform developed by Shade Innovations designed to withstand environmental extremes from wind, rain, heat and cold, with the new VINYL product adding a figurative window to the system, without compromising its performance.

The immediate benefit here are the views, but the fact that this allows for more naturally lit enclosures that might want to use these during the colder months is also a nice addition. While CE Pro readers may be more prone to introducing onto residential projects featuring outdoor patios or verandas, its hard not to see it as a solution fit for restaurants, bars and hospitality venues that want to have full-season outdoor spaces.

While this does mirror the offerings of other manufacturers like Phantom Shades and Universal screens, the fact that this is built on the KAOS platform adds a heightened level of durability to the product that sits above the usual motorized shade offering while also coming from a prominent manufacturer within the custom integration (CI) channel.

AVPro Global Announces New Design Services Across AV, Control Portfolio

https://www.cepro.com/news/avpro-global-announces-new-design-services-across-av-control-portfolio/627343/

AVPro Global Announces New Design Services Across AV, Control Portfolio

The new AVPro Design Services will support integrators across residential and commercial sectors by helping to design and implement systems using the company's portfolio.

Published: June 23, 2026Nick Boever

Image courtesy of AVPro Global Holdings

AVPro Global Holdings has announced the formation of an official systems design team for its family of products being called AVPro Design Services (AVS). According to the company, the ADS team will support integrators serving market segments such as Business & Corporate, Education, Government, Hospitality & Retail, Houses of Worship, Medical, and Luxury Residential. This is the first major announcement to come from the company since the appointment of Matt Murray as the new CEO in January.

How the new AVPro Design Services will work

According to AVPro Global, the ADS team will support the deployment and configuration of AVPro's comprehensive product portfolio, including AVPro Edge, AudioControl Pro, RTI, Bullet Train, Murideo, and ThenAudio brands, by designing systems that are "inherently stable, scalable, and perfectly tailored to the client."

Why integrators should take note

AVPro Global already has a diverse collection of brands that span the full breadth of an integrator's offerings including AV, control, power and other related accessories, with the new ADS team being able to work with partners on developing these collective brands into full-fledged systems throughout both residential and commercial spaces.

"Having an AVPro system architect on the integrator's side of the table is a powerful advantage, supporting application engineering, RTI programming, AV-over-IP consulting, home cinema layout, and more, while helping accelerate client proposal," said AVPro CEO Matt Murray in a statement.

This follows a growing trend among manufacturers and distributors establishing dedicated design services for integrators to make the most of both their products and portfolios.

While certainly a smart move by the companies to ensure that their products are performing optimally, these services, often tendered free to integrator partners, also offer a sense of security and quality assurance for the professionals staking their names and reputations on projects. Additionally, many integrators have spoken on the value of these services when designing and installing less familiar technology categories, allowing them to focus more on developing a lifestyle solution for their clients.

Integrators can learn more at: avproglobal.com/pages/ads-avpro-design-services

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Kanto Living Acquires Assets for Furrion Outdoor TV Product Line from Lippert

https://www.cepro.com/news/kanto-living-acquires-assets-for-furrion-outdoor-tv-product-line-from-lippert/627341/

Kanto Living Acquires Assets for Furrion Outdoor TV Product Line from Lippert

Furrion will join Kanto’s existing AV product line, which currently includes mounts, audio hardware and AV accessories.

Published: June 23, 2026Nick Boever

Furrion's Aurora Full-Sun Pro Series delivers 2,500-nits of brightness. Photo courtesy of Furrion

Furrion outdoor TVs have found a new home this summer as Kanto Living (Kanto) announced it has entered into an agreement with Lippert Components to acquire select assets associated with the Furrion outdoor TV product line. The acquisition includes outdoor televisions, related audio products, mounts, protective covers, customer relationships, inventory and manufacturing tooling.

Why integrators should take note

Kanto is a manufacturer that’s already tapped into many aspects of AV integration, specializing in audio products, TV mounts and other related accessories, making its acquisition of Furrion TVs a complimentary move for their product portfolio, and one that could stand to benefit integrators in the long run.

A major reason for that is because now the Furrion TV brand will be moving over to a manufacturer that is potentially going to better equipped to handle the needs of AV installers. While Furrion, and by consequence, Lippert, have formed plenty of relationships within the custom integration (CI) channel since its acquisition in 2021, the product always sat as an outlier within the brand’s broader focus: that being RVs, camping and watersports. Moving under the Kanto umbrella means moving to a company already entrenched in the AV space as it relates to support, distribution and business relationships.

“Furrion has built strong relationships throughout the outdoor entertainment category over many years, and we believe Kanto is well-positioned to continue supporting customers and growing the product line going forward,” said Mark Boessler, Sr Vice President, Lippert Aftermarket in a press release announcing the deal.

“Kanto understands the customer base, the products, and the importance of maintaining continuity throughout the transition.”

Echoing that sentiment in a separate statement, David Reid, CEO of Kanto Living said, “Our focus will be on ensuring continuity for customers while continuing to support and grow the product line over time.”

Details on the Kanto, Furrion deal

Specifics were not provided in the announcement, though Kanto expressed that it expected a smooth transition. No immediate disruption is expected to come to product availability or custom support per a statement provided by the company.

Tagged With: Audio Video, Furrion, Kanto Living, Lippert, Mergers & Acquisitions, TVs, outdoor TVs, outdoors

Kbis

Empava Debuts Smart WiFi Cold Plunge Tub for Home

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/empava-debuts-smart-wifi-cold-plunge-tub-for-home/

LOS ANGELES – Empava breaks the status quo in at-home cold therapy single-basin cold therapy solution brings professional-grade recovery to residential wellness spaces. The Smart WiFi Indoor/Outdoor Cold Plunge Tub, a fully self-contained recovery system designed to deliver professional-grade cold therapy anywhere at home, indoors or outdoors.

The plunge tub allows homeowners to seamlessly integrate performance-driven recovery into spa bathrooms, home gyms, patios, and outdoor wellness spaces through a single, streamlined solution. As cold therapy continues to move beyond gyms and training facilities, Empava's latest innovation answers growing demand for residential wellness products that combine performance, safety, and ease of use.

The Smart WiFi Cold Plunge Tub rapidly cools water from 86°F down to 37°F, supporting muscle recovery, circulation, and mental clarity, without the complexity of ice baths or multi-component plunge systems. "With homeowners placing greater emphasis on wellness-focused living, recovery is becoming a natural extension of residential design," said Ricky Cheng, President of Empava.

"Our Smart WiFi Indoor/Outdoor Cold Plunge Tub is designed to make cold therapy accessible year-round, whether that's in a spa bathroom, a home gym, or an outdoor retreat, without sacrificing performance, safety, or design." KEY FEATURES OF THE SMART WIFI INDOOR/OUTDOOR COLD PLUNGE TUB:

Rapid Cooling Performance: Built-in chiller cools water from 86°F to 37°F for effective cold therapy and recovery

Single-Basin, All-in-One Design: Integrated chiller, pump, and filtration system—no external equipment required

Smart WiFi Control: App-based temperature monitoring and adjustment with multiple built-in sensors

Enhanced Safety: Dual ASME-certified drains positioned 36 inches apart to help prevent suction hazards

Quiet, Efficient Operation: UL-certified, energy-efficient R32 compressor operates at just 65 dB

Indoor/Outdoor Durability: All-weather shell rated for temperatures from 19°F to 104°F

For more information about the Smart WiFi Indoor/Outdoor Cold Plunge Tub, please visit https://empava.com/.

Sharp Debuts New Premium Appliances at KBIS 2026

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/sharp-debuts-new-premium-appliances-at-kbis-2026/

EXHIBITOR NEWS

Sharp Debuts New Premium Appliances at KBIS 2026

MONTVALE, N.J., Feb. 17, 2026 /PRNewswire/ — Sharp Home Electronics Company of America (SHCA) is reinforcing its commitment to offering appliances that answer the evolving needs of today's household at this year's Kitchen & Bath Industry Show (KBIS). With a focus on style, innovation and Universal Design, Sharp is debuting more than 20 new products that reflect what consumers are prioritizing now: lasting value, elevated style and thoughtful functionality that supports every generation.

"At Sharp, we design appliances that stay in step with your life today and in your future," said Grace Dolan, Senior Vice President of SHCA. "Homeowners are prioritizing quality over square footage, and choosing appliances that look built-in, work beautifully, and hold up over time. With Gen X driving spending in 2026 and often purchasing for households with evolving needs, our new kitchen suite brings together elevated style, intuitive technology, and Universal Design to help families cook with confidence for years to come."

Sharp advances cooking speed and performance with the Sharp Celerity High-Speed Oven (SWA3099MS). The 30-inch wall oven combines an industry-first Golden Heater, engineered to reach high temperatures quickly, with True European Convection and inverter-controlled microwave power to dramatically cut cook times, while still achieving a crisp, golden outside and moist, tender center. A whole chicken can be ready up to three times faster than in a conventional oven. With nine cooking modes, including air fry, grill, microwave, convection bake and roast options, it is a versatile and time-saving solution for busy households.

Sharp is expanding its category-defining Microwave Drawer Oven (SMD2479JS) with the Deco Series, adding Elegant White (SMD2479MW) and Matte Black (SMD2479MB) finishes designed to complement today's most popular kitchen palettes. Invented by Sharp, the Microwave Drawer rethinks the standard swing-door microwave with a sliding drawer that glides open for easy access. Typically installed below the counter, it reduces reaching overhead and bending, making loading and unloading more comfortable and safer. Features, such as Easy Wave Open for touchless operation and smart connectivity, add convenience and help kitchens run more smoothly. Guided by universal design principles, it's built to work well for more people, across more stages of life.

Rounding out the 2026 suite, Sharp is introducing new microwave ovens, counter-depth refrigerators, ranges, and dishwashers built for modern routines. New countertop microwave options include the 3-in-1 Countertop Microwave Oven (SMC0985KS), which combines microwave, air fry and convection in a compact footprint. Sharp's latest counter-depth refrigerators emphasize capacity and smarter organization with a streamlined, built-in look, while new dishwashers deliver powerful cleaning with Library Quiet operation ranging from 44 to 49 dBA.

As the modern home reflects a wider range of lifestyles and abilities, Sharp remains committed to creating appliances that make everyday living easier for more people, longer.

KBIS 2026 attendees can experience the new products at Sharp's booth (#S25091, Orange County Convention Center).

About Sharp Home Electronics Company of America

SHCA is the Consumer Products Division of Sharp Electronics Corporation, the U.S. subsidiary of Sharp Corporation. Sharp is the only Japanese brand in the U.S. to offer a complete portfolio of major kitchen appliances, designed around people and backed by a long-standing commitment to quality and reliability. Sharp's kitchen portfolio includes its category-defining Sharp Microwave Drawer ovens, Celerity High-Speed Ovens, SuperSteam+ ovens, and Sharp Carousel microwave ovens. The company's broader consumer portfolio also includes AQUOS TVs and Plasmacluster Ion air purifiers. SHCA operates through three distinct groups. Sharp Electronics Marketing Company of America (SEMCA) leads sales and brand strategy from New Jersey. Sharp Manufacturing Company of America (SMCA) produces cooking appliances in Memphis, TN and Sharp Services and Support Group (SSG) provides nationwide customer service, warranties, and technical support.

Sharp Corporation is named among the top electronics companies on Fortune's World's Most Admired Companies for 2026 while Sharp Electronics Corporation is recognized as a 2025 Best Places to Work in NJ for the fifth consecutive year. It has received multiple honors including the Globee Gold Award for Customer Service Champion of the Year.

Sharp Unveils Stylish Compact Kitchen Appliances

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/sharp-unveils-stylish-compact-kitchen-appliances/

Sharp Unveils Stylish Compact Kitchen Appliances

Feb 19, 2026

MONTVALE, N.J., Feb. 17, 2026 /PRNewswire/ — Sharp Home Electronics Company of America (SHCA), the consumer division of Sharp Electronics Corporation, today announced new additions to its suite of compact kitchen appliances that bring premium style to small spaces, and answer the needs of those looking for high design and innovation.

According to data from Sharp and Apartment Therapy, 66 percent of people living in small spaces struggle to find compact appliance options that feel well-designed, as opposed to "apartment-grade," and 59 percent are frustrated with inefficient storage in their kitchens. With over 20 new products debuting at the 2026 Kitchen & Bath Industry Show (KBIS) from February 17 – 19, 2026, Sharp addresses the functionality needs of kitchens big and small, showing that technology and design in the kitchen can move in step with your needs, and find its place even in the smallest spaces.

"At Sharp, we design products that work in step with our customers' living spaces and needs," said Grace Dolan, Senior Vice President of SHCA. "By listening closely to our customers, we understand the importance of offering both enhanced technology and stunning design for small kitchens. The newest products reflect Sharp's commitment to impacting daily living through accessible and enjoyable cooking and kitchen experiences."

Among the new appliances is the 24″ Counter-Depth French Door Refrigerator (SJG1166SNS) that boasts a luxurious exterior design and built-in look to accommodate a small kitchen. Born from

customer affection for Sharp's 24″ Bottom-Freezer Counter Depth Refrigerator, this new model arrives in Spring 2026 with smart storage and organization solutions, now paired with French doors to appeal to wider tastes and needs.

Another highlight of the new compact kitchen appliances is the 24″ Wall Oven (SWA2462SNS), available Spring 2026. Its sleek aesthetic elevates small kitchen design, while it offers a true European convection oven with an air fryer.

Sharp's expanded line of compact kitchen appliances also includes the Sharp 24″ Counter-Depth Refrigerator (SJB10455NS) and Sharp 24″ Range Hood (SHC2443SNS). These join the beloved Convection Microwave Drawer™ Oven (SMD2499FS), Steam Oven (SSC2489GS), Over-The-Range Microwave Oven (SMO1461GS), Dishwasher (SDW4523MS) and Cooktops (SC42442FB and SCH2443GB).

Sharp's booth at KBIS (#S25091) is showcasing both its compact kitchen appliances and full-size appliance suite. For more information, visit https://www.sharpusa.com.

About Sharp Home Electronics Company of America

SHCA is the Consumer Products Division of Sharp Electronics Corporation, the U.S. subsidiary of Sharp Corporation. Sharp is the only Japanese brand in the U.S. to offer a complete portfolio of major kitchen appliances, designed around people and backed by a long-standing commitment to quality and reliability.

Sharp's kitchen portfolio includes its category-defining Sharp Microwave Drawer™ ovens, Celerity™ High-Speed Ovens, SuperSteam+™ ovens, and Sharp Carousel® microwave ovens. The company's broader consumer portfolio also includes AQUOS™ TVs and Plasmacluster® Ion air purifiers. SHCA operates through three distinct groups.

Sharp Corporation is named among the top electronics companies on Fortune's World's Most Admired Companies for 2026 while Sharp Electronics Corporation is recognized as a 2025 Best Places to Work in NJ for the fifth consecutive year. It has received multiple honors including the Globee Gold Award for Customer Service Champion of the Year.

Sharp, AQUOS, Carousel, Microwave Drawer, Celerity, SuperSteam+, Plasmacluster, and all related trademarks are trademarks or registered trademarks of Sharp Corporation and/or its affiliated companies. All other trademarks are the property of their respective owners.

About Apartment Therapy Media

Founded in 2001 and developed into a media company in 2005, Apartment Therapy Media helps people make their homes more organized, healthy, and beautiful by connecting them to a wealth of resources, ideas, and community through its brands, Apartment Therapy, The Kitchn, Cubby, and Dorm Therapy.

IWSH Launches Community Plumbing Challenge in L.A.

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/iwsh-launches-community-plumbing-challenge-in-l-a/

EXHIBITOR NEWS

IWSH Launches Community Plumbing Challenge in L.A.

Los Angeles, Calif. (Feb. 18, 2026) — The International Water, Sanitation and Hygiene Foundation (IWSH), the public charity of IAPMO, will lead a new IWSH Community Plumbing Challenge this summer to upgrade critical plumbing infrastructure at Los Angeles Mission, a nonprofit serving individuals and families experiencing homelessness in downtown Los Angeles.

Los Angeles Mission supports more than 1,000 people each day, providing access to meals, showers, restrooms and safe water. However, aging plumbing systems marked by frequent leaks, drainage backups and inefficient fixtures have placed strain on daily operations and risked service interruptions for vulnerable community members. Reliable, professionally installed plumbing is essential to ensuring uninterrupted access to clean water and sanitation.

Through this Community Plumbing Challenge, IWSH is mobilizing skilled volunteer plumbers and working alongside Southern California labor organizations, while leveraging the codes, standards and technical expertise of IAPMO to deliver targeted upgrades throughout the Mission's main building. The project reflects a shared legacy of service and public health leadership as IAPMO marks its 100th year advancing safe, sustainable plumbing systems and IWSH approaches its 10th year. Planned improvements include replacing aging fixtures like toilets and sinks; addressing critical repairs; and improving overall system performance. Every upgrade prioritizes water efficiency, code compliance and long-term durability.

"Plumbing is essential infrastructure for public health, dignity and stability," said Robyn Fischer, IWSH senior director for North America. "By bringing together skilled plumbers, quality products and thoughtful project design, grounded in the IAPMO ecosystem, this Community Plumbing Challenge will help Los Angeles Mission focus on what it does best, supporting people on their path out of homelessness, while ensuring the systems behind the walls are safe, reliable and built to last."

IWSH Community Plumbing Challenges are intentionally small in scale but designed for large, replicable impact. Each project serves as a blueprint, demonstrating how focused investments in skilled labor and quality products can strengthen community organizations, reduce operational costs, and improve health outcomes.

IWSH invites manufacturers and industry partners to support this essential project through financial contributions or in-kind product donations. Current needs include water-efficient fixtures and fittings, valves and piping, drainage components, tools and safety supplies, and project sponsorships. One hundred percent of every contribution directly supports project impact, funding skilled labor, project design and specifications, quality materials, and sustainable solutions.

By partnering with IWSH, supporters demonstrate measurable impact, including improved health and sanitation, reduced maintenance costs, and uninterrupted services for the individuals and families served by Los Angeles Mission, while elevating the essential role of professional plumbing in public health.

To learn more about sponsorship opportunities, contact Robyn Fischer, IWSH senior director for North America, at robyn.fischer@iapmo.org.

The International Water, Sanitation and Hygiene Foundation (IWSH) is a 501(c)(3) organization and the public charity of IAPMO. Founded in 2016, IWSH mobilizes the plumbing industry for good, providing clean drinking water, safe sanitation, and new career pathways to underserved low-income and Indigenous communities through demonstration projects designed for scale.

WOODCONCEPT Debuts New Cabinetry at KBIS 2026

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/woodconcept-debuts-new-cabinetry-at-kbis-2026/

WOODCONCEPT Debuts New Cabinetry at KBIS 2026

Orlando, FL — WOODCONCEPT, a leading cabinetry brand serving dealers, designers, and developers, will showcase its latest cabinetry collections at the 2026 Kitchen & Bath Industry Show (KBIS) in Orlando at Booth #S19143.

Visitors will experience new door styles, expanded finish options, and thoughtfully designed kitchen displays that highlight the company's commitment to quality craftsmanship, scalable production, and dependable service. From showroom dealers to multi-unit housing developers, WOODCONCEPT provides cabinetry solutions designed to support growth and long-term partnerships.

"We're excited to connect with industry professionals at KBIS and demonstrate how our cabinetry combines design excellence with operational reliability," said Kevin Wang, CEO.

Industry professionals are invited to visit Booth #S19143 to explore partnership opportunities and discover the company's newest offerings.

Cambria Unveils 'Style Without Limits' at KBIS 2026

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/cambria-unveils-style-without-limits-at-kbis-2026/

EXHIBITOR NEWS

Cambria Unveils 'Style Without Limits' at KBIS 2026

Le Sueur, MN (February 17, 2026) — Cambria, the premier producer of American-made natural quartz surfaces, returns to the 2026 Kitchen & Bath Industry Show (KBIS) with Style Without Limits, an immersive booth experience that redefines how quartz surfaces are used throughout the home. Located in West Hall, Booth W749, the exhibit runs February 17–19 in Orlando.

Moving beyond the countertop, Cambria showcases quartz as an architectural surface, integrated across kitchens, baths, walls, and floors through a series of large-scale installations, new applications, and the debut of its latest designs. "We're showing a new way of designing with Cambria," said Summer Kath, Executive Vice President of Design at Cambria. "By extending it into walls and floors, we're enabling cohesive, high-performance spaces that feel intentional and enduring."

Must-See Innovations

Through immersive architectural installations, visitors will experience Cambria's "Style Without Limits," where breathtaking quartz designs push creative and technical limits.

A Master Class in Kitchen Design: A statement kitchen blends modern architecture with refined detailing. Two new designs anchor the space: St. Isley is featured on the counters, shelving, and island in Cambria Satin and Polished finishes, while Traymore Bay in Cambria Satin finish appears on the hood surround and coffee bar, highlighting its tonal depth.

The 1cm Luxury Spa: A fully clad primary spa demonstrates Cambria's ultra-thin 1cm quartz surfaces in grout-free applications ideal for walls, showers, vanities, and floors—delivering durability without visual interruption.

The spa is a stunning example of multiple Cambria designs and finishes working in harmony. Among them: A fully clad double shower in 1cm Kenwood in Cambria Satin, with a tranquil pairing of 1cm Kenwood in Polished and 1cm Templeton in Cambria Satin forming the durable modern floor design. Visitors will also experience a full-height accent wall featuring Inverness Frost enhanced by artistic floral appliqués crafted from Hermitage in a mix of Polished and Cambria Matte finishes.

The Trends Wall: An art installation composed of a mix of materials and lighting, the trends wall highlights Cambria designs in multiple finishes alongside warm walnut details and complementary paint hues.

New Quartz Designs Debuting at KBIS

The booth serves as the official KBIS debut for Cambria's most recent design arrivals, each representing a leap forward in aesthetics, depth, and detail.

- St. Isley Bold movement with blue-gray veining and warm undertones

- Kenwood Soft tonal shifts with a grounded, refined look

- Claremont Clean, flowing lines in a modern neutral palette

- Traymore Bay Balanced warm-cool tones with organic depth

"Innovation at Cambria is about creating materials that elevate how people live," Kath added. "These designs are meant to be felt as much as seen."

Collaborative Vignettes and Partnerships

The booth features high-end cabinetry from MasterBrand Cabinets, integrating its premium Omega cabinetry with Cambria's St. Isley and Traymore Bay designs to create a high-performance kitchen environment. Additional partner features include fixtures by Kohler, lighting by Hammerton, and furniture by Arteriors.

Cambria can also be found in the KBIS booths of Benjamin Moore and True Residential. Both selected Cambria designs as perfect complements to their 2026 colors of the year. To coordinate with its espresso-hued Silhouette AF-655, Benjamin Moore chose Cambria's Remington Brass in Cambria Satin finish for a kitchen island, coffee bar, and backsplash. Family-owned, American-made appliance brand True Residential selected Hermitage with Cambria Matte finish on its main countertop,

backsplash, and island to complement its color of the year.

Gain Insight into Kitchen & Bath Trends

Attendees are invited to hear Cambria Executive Vice President of Design Summer Kath speak at the adjacent International Builders' Show (IBS) on Wednesday, February 18, at 4pm. Her session, "Design You Can Feel: The Trends, Materials & Principles Behind Kitchens & Baths Built to Last," will explore the shift toward tactile luxury in the home.

About Cambria

Founded in 2000, Cambria is the leading family-owned, American-made producer of natural quartz surfaces. Cambria's innovative and iconic quartz designs are stain resistant, nonporous, durable, and maintenance free, backed by a transferable Full Lifetime Warranty.

New VIATERA Quartz Colors Launch at KBIS 2026

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/new-viatera-quartz-colors-launch-at-kbis-2026/

ORLANDO, Fla. – LX Hausys America Inc., an innovative manufacturer of building and decorative materials, is introducing six new VIATERA quartz colors at this year's KBIS.

The new introductions span three VIATERA collections and showcase a range of warm neutrals, nature-inspired movement and refined aesthetics designed to elevate today's kitchens and baths.

Three of the six new VIATERA colors introduced for 2026—Solea, Ocean Ridge, and Midnight Ember Brushed—are manufactured at LX Hausys' state-of-the-art quartz surface facility in Adairsville, Ga. Solea and Ocean Ridge are also BABA compliant, meeting the requirements of the Build America, Buy America (BABA) Act.

Two of the new colors, Perla Verde and Crystallo Vera, feature TrueView™, LX Hausys' next-generation, high-resolution digital infusion technology for VIATERA surfaces. TrueView delivers the realism of natural stone, deeper visual continuity and enhanced design flexibility while maintaining the durability and sustainability of quartz.

VIATERA colors with TrueView technology feature thru-vein design (also known as full body).

Winter Grove, Perla Verde, and Crystallo Vera feature NeoQ™, a next-generation technology that incorporates up to 90% post-consumer recycled content while delivering the same hardness, durability, and non-porous performance as premium quartz.

"We're excited to debut these six new VIATERA colors at KBIS 2026," said Mike Morici, vice president of surfaces sales and channel management at LX Hausys America. "Each design reflects the evolving preferences of today's designers and homeowners, offering a thoughtful balance of natural inspiration, advanced surface technology and timeless style across the VIATERA brand."

Two new colors join the VIATERA Suprema Collection:

Solea radiates quiet warmth and serene beauty. Its soft white base is traced with broad, diffused veins of gold and taupe, capturing the gentle glow of sunlight drifting across a calm horizon.

Ocean Ridge captures the meeting of deep navy and sunlit hues. Fine navy veins ripple alongside soft, shadowy waves that drift across an off-white foundation, expressing the quiet movement of tides.

Two new colors join the VIATERA Masterpiece Collection:

Midnight Ember Brushed emanates depth and refined warmth. Refined veins of gold and white flicker across a foundation of warm black, recalling the final embers glowing in the night.

Winter Grove evokes the stillness of a snow-covered forest. Beneath its white expanse, soft hints of sage green and delicate shadow-like veins emerge, mirroring the quiet patterns of branches in winter light.

Two new colors join the VIATERA Quartzite Collection:

Perla Verde reveals a soft gray foundation touched with sage green and crossed by veins of deep green and brown. Its organic, layered beauty reflects the rhythm of nature, offering a neutral palette that feels balanced, sophisticated, and full of depth.

Crystallo Vera embodies refined simplicity. Its crystal-like white surface reveals subtle tone-on-tone variations that create a luminous, translucent impression.

LX Hausys Debuts Four New HIMACS Colors at KBIS 2026

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/lx-hausys-debuts-four-new-himacs-colors-at-kbis-2026/

ORLANDO, Fla. – LX Hausys Debuts Four New HIMACS Colors at KBIS 2026

LX Hausys America Inc., an innovative manufacturer of building and decorative materials, is introducing four new HIMACS solid surface colors at this year's KBIS. Designed for commercial and residential interiors, the new colors reflect the stunning visual looks needed for today's modern environments ranging from hospitality and wellness areas to retail and workplace settings.

Expanding the HIMACS Calacatta and Terrazzo collections, the new colors also bring superior durability, easy cleanability and dynamic thermoforming capabilities, allowing designers the freedom to create the expressive surface designs they envision.

"Commercial interior designers are looking for surfaces that can help them achieve their design visions, whether that's making a statement for a reception area or providing a sense of calm for a spa," said Mike Morici, vice president of surfaces sales and channel management at LX Hausys America. "These new HIMACS colors deliver all of that, and more. From refined Italian Calacatta stone to the timeless look of Terrazzo, these colors offer a thoughtful balance of natural inspiration and refined aesthetics. Their design versatility, coupled with their superior, long-lasting performance, make them the ideal solution for any commercial interior."

Two new colors join the HIMACS Calacatta Collection:

Calacatta Full Moon features long, flowing veins of varying thickness that move harmoniously across a rich cream-toned base. Subtle tonal variations and organic movement evoke the natural artistry of Italian stone, while a faint, light-catching sparkle follows the veining, adding depth and a gentle,

vein-traced radiance.

Calacatta Snow Moon presents a soft, light-toned base accented by a balanced interplay of thin and bold veining, forming a sophisticated Calacatta pattern. A delicate, luminous shimmer is infused into the base, capturing and diffusing light for a calm, glowing effect.

Two new colors join the HIMACS Terrazzo Collection:

Terrazzo Ulivo features an off-white base accented with terrazzo speckles in natural olive and gray-green tones. Inspired by traditional Italian terrazzo incorporating olive stone fragments, this color brings a sense of heritage and artisanal craftsmanship to any space.

Terrazzo Nuvola combines light, cloud-like chips with deeper tones that evoke wildflowers in a pine forest. Inspired by the delicate beauty of flowers in bloom, it captures the essence of nature in motion.

All colors are backed by LX Hausys' 15-year limited warranty.

HIMACS is a durable, nonporous solid surface material made from a blend of acrylic, natural minerals and pigments. Seamless, repairable and hygienic, HIMACS is ideal for a wide range of interior applications, from countertops and wall panels to custom furniture and commercial surfaces. Its thermoformable properties enable creative freedom in design, while a wide palette of colors and patterns—including natural stone looks, solid hues and terrazzo—offers extensive aesthetic versatility.

LX Hausys established its first solid surface manufacturing plant in the U.S. in Adairsville, Ga., in 2005. Today, the company operates three production lines within a facility spanning more than 293,000 square feet that employs more than 160 associates. LX Hausys is the only manufacturer in the U.S. with a plant that produces both solid surface and quartz in the same location.

LX Hausys Debuts BORTE Premium Panel System at KBIS

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/lx-hausys-debuts-borte-premium-panel-system-at-kbis/

LX Hausys Debuts BORTE Premium Panel System at KBIS

ORLANDO, Fla. – LX Hausys America Inc. (Booth #W1429), an innovative manufacturer of building and decorative materials, is launching a new premium panel system, BORTE, at this year's KBIS. Bringing the innovative design, advanced technology and sustainability benefits for which LX Hausys is known, BORTE offers residential and commercial design professionals a new option for reimagining kitchen, bathroom and other spaces with elevated aesthetics, exceptional durability and easy maintenance.

BORTE is debuting with three distinctive collections and its Complete Product Program, a suite of edgebands, films, profiles and foil that perfectly coordinate with the panels. Each element of the program allows for a seamless and consistent design throughout any space while offering greater design diversity and a premium quality look. All BORTE edgebands are precisely color-matched to the panel colors and are available in PUR/EVA and Zero-joint edge types in widths of 22mm, 41mm and 45mm.

BORTE's three debuting collections were developed by LX Hausys' internationally renowned and award-winning Global Design Team based in Seoul, South Korea. Drawing on their extensive global trend research capabilities and U.S. customer feedback, the perfectly curated mix of patterns, hues and textures across the three collections capture the design desires of homeowners today, making BORTE an ideal solution for cabinets, closets, furniture and other applications across an array of interiors.

The new BORTE colors span three distinct collections. The Reserve Collection, available in nine colors, celebrates surfaces shaped by texture, detail and craftsmanship. Inspired by hand-worked materials and refined finishes, each option highlights depth, movement and character designed to be seen, touched and lived with. The Hue Collection, available in 20 colors, explores color as atmosphere, from quiet neutrals to deeper, more expressive tones. Inspired by light, landscape and everyday environments, each shade is designed to shape mood, enhance space, and create a feeling of calm confidence in modern interiors. The Origin Collection is rooted in the modern sophistication of natural materials, drawing from woods, soft finishes, and enduring forms. Available in 18 colors, these surfaces bring warmth and balance to interiors, creating spaces that feel grounded, welcoming, and thoughtfully composed.

Every BORTE surface features LX Hausys' Super Matte Resistant (SMR) technology. SMR is an industry-leading coating innovation that brings a refined aesthetic and an embossed, tailored texture to create an authentic feel. Proven in tests to prevent stains, scratches and fingerprint smudges, BORTE surfaces with SMR technology meet the highest levels of design and durability, and allow for easy maintenance.

"A premium panel can greatly enhance the look and feel of a kitchen, bath or living space, instantly adding value and personal satisfaction," said K.T. Kang, business director of LX Hausys BORTE Panel. "Expertly designed and featuring our SMR technology, these collections will immediately show designers, homebuilders and homeowners how our BORTE panel system can elevate any space."

BORTE supports healthier indoor environments through its GREENGUARD Gold certification and its CARB P2 certification for low formaldehyde emissions. For customers seeking sustainable options, BORTE panels can be requested with a bio-based coating. Customers can also request BORTE panels come with the polymer film containing post-consumer recycled content.

BORTE panels are manufactured using a medium-density fiberboard (MDF) core bonded with environmentally friendly glue and a high-performance polymer film with trend-setting designs laminated on the surface, while the back side is finished with a low-pressure melamine (LPM). The result is a product that offers greater cost, stability, performance and design advantages over wood and other similar products such as TFL, HPL or high-performance HPL. BORTE surfaces come in a 4-by-8-foot panel size and 18 mm thick.

Designers, home builders and others can learn more about BORTE at lxhausys.com/us/products/borte-panel. BORTE samples can be requested by contacting the BORTE Product Management Team at jooheecha@lxhausys.com.

True Caliber Reveals 2026 Color of the Year: Espresso

https://kbis.com/exhibitor_news/true-caliber-reveals-2026-color-of-the-year-espresso/

EXHIBITOR NEWS

True Caliber Reveals 2026 Color of the Year: Espresso

Feb 17, 2026

True Caliber, where professional-grade refrigeration meets precision grilling for the luxury home, proudly unveils its 2026 Color of the Year: Espresso. A deep, full-bodied brown with subtle velvet undertones, Espresso joins True Caliber's expansive collection of finishes as a sophisticated, dark neutral.

Reminiscent of a perfectly pulled ristretto, Espresso delivers richness and depth without visual weight, adding warmth and balance to both modern and classic spaces. Unlike a standard brown, this nuanced finish possesses a sense of permanence and quiet luxury, pairing effortlessly with natural materials, warm metals, and layered textures.

"Espresso was designed to offer a sense of stability and focus within the home," remarks Chelsea Bothe, Brand & Marketing Manager at True Caliber. "It exudes a refined and understated elegance, yielding a finish that feels intentional and effortlessly at home in any well-designed kitchen. Whether anchoring a bright, modern space or enriching a traditional one, Espresso transforms any space into an inviting sanctuary that is both contemporary and enduring."

The new hue's ability to convey a sense of ease and polish makes it an ideal fit for both interior kitchens and outdoor entertaining suites. As with all True Caliber finishes, Espresso is available across the full range of full-size and indoor/outdoor undercounter refrigeration units and grills, allowing for seamless integration throughout the home.

The addition of the Espresso colorway, along with the reintroduction of its legacy Crimson finish, to True Caliber's Build Your True Program of curated custom finish and hardware options, now allows designers and homeowners a choice of 96 alluring color combinations. These standard finishes include Olive, Champagne, Bluestone, Sage, Juniper, Gloss Black, Matte Black, Ultra Matte Black, Emerald, Cobalt, Matte White, Antique White, Stainless Steel, and the aforementioned Crimson. Complementary hardware options include Stainless Steel, Copper, Brass, Pewter, Gold, and Chrome.

Feedburner

Nice Expands U.S. Representation with Thomasson Marketing Group

https://www.securitysales.com/news/nice-representation-thomasson-marketing-group/619335/

Nice Expands U.S. Representation with Thomasson Marketing Group

New Nice partnership with Thomasson Marketing Group strengthens dealer support and drives growth for 2GIG solutions.

Published: June 12, 2026SSI Staff

CARLSBAD, Calif. — Smart home and business solutions provider Nice recently announced a new partnership with Thomasson Marketing Group, Inc. (TMG), further strengthening Nice North America's regional representation and support for its 2GIG security solutions across the Pacific Western United States.

Working closely with Nice's regional sales managers (RSMs), TMG "will provide local dealers and distribution partners with an additional layer of field support, resources and expertise," according to the company announcement.

This strategic partnership "reinforces Nice North America's ongoing commitment to expanding localized sales expertise, dealer engagement and market development within the security and smart home channel," the announcement says.

Why Did Nice Partner with Thomasson Marketing Group?

"Regional representation plays a critical role in how we support our partners and drive growth in key markets," says Donnie McVicker, chief sales officer of Nice North America, in the company announcement. "Thomasson Marketing Group brings strong relationships, deep industry knowledge, and a proven ability to execute at the local level.

"Their focus on dealer engagement and sell-through initiatives will help expand the reach of our 2GIG portfolio and support our partners' success across this important region," he says.

With this partnership, Thomasson Marketing Group will represent 2GIG solutions across Alaska, Arizona, California, Colorado, Hawaii, Idaho, Montana, New Mexico, Nevada, Oregon, Utah, Washington and Wyoming, the announcement says.

Led by president Jordan R. Thomasson, TMG "has built a strong reputation for delivering strategic sales representation and channel development within the security and low voltage electronics industries," according to the company announcement.

Through this relationship, Nice North America "continues to invest in its regional representation strategy, ensuring dealers and distributors have access to the resources, expertise and support needed to succeed in an increasingly competitive market," the announcement says.

"We're excited to partner with Nice North America and represent the 2GIG portfolio across such a dynamic region," says Thomasson in the announcement. "2GIG continues to be a trusted name in the

security and smart home space, and we look forward to helping dealers grow their businesses through strong local support and market development.”

Tagged With: 2GIG, Nice, Nice North America

Shark Attack Near Fla. Naval Base: Surveillance Videos of the Week

https://www.securitysales.com/news/shark-attack-florida-naval-base-surveillance-videos-week/619323/

Shark Attack Near Fla. Naval Base: Surveillance Videos of the Week

Animals of all sizes take center stage in the latest batch of Surveillance Videos of the Week. From a shark attack to a dog rescue to an alligator giving an assist to a local police department, we saw creatures on camera going viral across news reels around the world this week.

We also saw New York Knicks fans celebrate the team’s historic comeback in Game 3 of the 2026 NBA Finals at Madison Square Garden by taking to the streets and, for some reason, throwing eggs at San Antonio Spurs superstar center Victor Wembanyama as he got off the team bus and tried to go into the hotel after the game.

Other surveillance videos this week include a Massachusetts mother lashing out at a graduation ceremony, flash floods across the Midwestern U.S. and someone setting up a burning cross in a historic Chicago park.

Click here to check out the latest batch of Surveillance Videos of the Week. Send your suggestions for future editions to digital editor Craig MacCormack at craig.maccormack@emeraldx.com.

IQSIGHT Appoints Wilkinson as Vice President of Sales, North America

https://www.securitysales.com/news/iqsight-wilkinson-vice-president-sales-north-america/619317/

IQSIGHT Appoints Wilkinson as Vice President of Sales, North America

Wilkinson will be responsible for accelerating IQSIGHT's sales growth and deepening engagement with its channel partners and customers.

Published: June 11, 2026SSI Staff

IQSIGHT recently announced Ted Wilkinson as vice president of sales, North America

Wilkinson will be responsible for accelerating sales growth, executing regional go-to-market strategy and deepening engagement with IQSIGHT’s channel partners and customers

He has more than three decades of experience in the technology sector

EINDHOVEN, Netherlands — Global intelligence-first video security provider IQSIGHT recently announced that security and technology industry leader Ted Wilkinson has joined its executive team as vice president of sales, North America.

In his new role, Wilkinson “will be responsible for accelerating sales growth, executing regional go-to-market strategy and deepening engagement with IQSIGHT’s channel partners and customers,” the company announcement says.

“Ted brings the right combination of industry insight and execution expertise to lead our North American team and align the regional sales efforts with our broader global strategy,” says Sam Ward, chief commercial officer, global sales, at IQSIGHT, in the announcement.

“He is committed to cultivating loyalty with our channel partners and customers by empowering the sales team to meet market needs and unlock new opportunities for growth,” he says.

Wilkinson has more than three decades of experience and “has been instrumental in developing successful key account and channel strategies, scalable go-to-market models and effective initiatives that build stronger customer and partner relationships,” according to the IQSIGHT announcement.

He has “a proven ability to lead high-performing teams, deliver consistent results and expand market presence,” the announcement says.

“IQSIGHT’s core strengths in visual intelligence and delivering high-quality, reliable solutions create an excellent foundation for growth,” says Wilkinson in the company announcement. “I look forward to working with the passionate and committed team in North America to deliver an exceptional customer experience providing technologies that help organizations reduce risk, improve safety and keep operations running smoothly.”

Posted In: News

Tagged With: IQSIGHT

World Fire Congress Advances Global Fire Service Collaboration

https://www.securitysales.com/news/world-fire-congress-global-fire-service-collaboration-new-research-framework/619312/

World Fire Congress Advances Global Fire Service Collaboration

The World Fire Congress (WFC) has named the Metropolitan Fire Chiefs Association (Metro Chiefs), a section of the National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) and the International Association of Fire Chiefs (IAFC), to serve as its Secretariat, according to an association announcement.

The decision “establishes a long-term coordination and continuity framework designed to strengthen global collaboration across the fire and emergency services profession,” the announcement says.

The Secretariat structure “will provide continuity between Congresses, preserve institutional knowledge, support host-nation coordination and strengthen sustained international engagement on emerging fire and life safety challenges,” according to the association announcement.

“It is an honor for the Metropolitan Fire Chiefs Association to serve as the Secretariat for the World Fire Congress,” says Otto Drozd III, executive secretary of Metro Chiefs, in the announcement. “What is being established through this partnership is far more than operational coordination for a single event.

“It is the long-term infrastructure designed to support continuity, global engagement and sustained collaboration for future Congresses and the international fire and emergency services community. With the support of NFPA and IAFC, combined with the research and learning efforts being advanced through UL Research Institutes’ Fire Safety Research Institute, the World Fire Congress is building a

strong and enduring foundation capable of supporting global cooperation for generations to come," he says.

The World Fire Congress is a biennial global forum that "brings together fire and emergency service leaders to strengthen international cooperation, share knowledge and advance evidence-informed dialogue on evolving fire and life safety challenges impacting communities worldwide," according to the announcement.

Topics include firefighter health and safety, climate-driven disasters, structural fires, wildfires, emerging technologies, prevention, response, recovery and resilience.

The 2026 World Fire Congress will take place Sept. 8-9 at the QEII Conference Centre in Westminster, London, hosted by the United Kingdom and organized by the National Fire Chiefs Council (NFCC).

In addition to the Secretariat announcement, the World Fire Congress confirmed that UL Research Institutes' Fire Safety Research Institute (ULRI) "will support the Congress' learning, research and insight efforts by developing global Communities of Practice designed to sustain collaboration between Congresses," the announcement says.

Dubai, United Arab Emirates is scheduled to host the Congress in 2028, and proposals are currently being accepted for prospective host nations for 2030.

Lessing Gold, Partner, Mitchell Silberberg & Knupp: Best Advice

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/lessing-gold-mitchell-silberberg-knupp-best-advice/619305/

Lessing Gold, Partner, Mitchell Silberberg & Knupp: Best Advice

Gold reveals the best advice he's ever gotten, gives pointers to security industry pros on the rise and names an inspiration for the sector.

Published: June 11, 2026SSI Staff

Our Best Advice Q&A; series reaches triple digits today and there's no one more worthy of being the 100th person to participate than 2004 _SSI_ Industry Hall of Fame inductee Lessing Gold, partner at Mitchell Silberberg & Knupp. He shares the best advice he's ever heard, gives tips to security industry newcomers and names a person to whom all others in the sector should always listen.

Security Sales & Integration: What's the best piece of advice you've ever received?

Lessing Gold: Retain your sense of humor.

SSI: What advice would you give to those looking to achieve success in the security industry?

Gold: Always tell the truth and be honest and straightforward with your customers and your suppliers. If a job is beyond the scope of your ability or knowledge, don't accept it.

SSI: If you could point to one person in the security industry and tell up-and-comers, "Make sure to listen to what they have to say," whom would you pick and why?

Gold: Peter Raymond. He knows the industry inside and out. He takes pride in what he does and is always ready to share his knowledge with new and upcoming men and women entering the industry. If

he tells you something, listen!

Posted In: Insights

Tagged With: Mitchell Silberberg & Knupp

Why Early Access Planning Is Now Mission-Critical at Data Centers

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/why-early-access-planning-is-now-mission-critical-at-data-centers/619295/

Why Early Access Planning Is Now Mission-Critical at Data Centers

The rapid expansion of hyperscale and colocation data centers is reshaping how project teams think about speed, scale and risk.

Physical security and access control are no longer considerations that can be finalized late in the design process. Instead, they must be embedded early and approached as integral components of the overall delivery strategy.

At the center of this evolution is a simple reality: in mission-critical environments, delays are costly, and inconsistency introduces risk. The way doors, frames, hardware and access control systems are designed, specified and coordinated can have a measurable impact on project timelines, commissioning and long-term operations.

The Shift Toward Early-Stage Security Integration

Traditionally, access control and door hardware are addressed after core architectural and engineering decisions are already in place. In many commercial applications, sequencing may still work. In hyperscale and colocation data centers, however, this reactive approach often leads to inefficiencies.

Late-stage coordination frequently results in increased RFIs as discrepancies emerge between drawings and real-world conditions, change orders driven by incompatibility between hardware and access control systems, and rework that disrupts already compressed construction schedules.

For integrators and consultants, this reactive model creates unnecessary complexity and limits the ability to influence outcomes.

Forward-thinking data center owners and operators are taking a different approach. They are bringing security consultants, door hardware experts and access control integrators into the conversation much earlier, often during schematic design or design development phases.

This shift allows project teams to establish clarity around system requirements, performance expectations and installation constraints before they become problems in the field.

Standardization as a Tool for Speed and Scale

One of the most significant trends in modern data center development is the move toward standardization. Hyperscale operators are deploying repeatable design models across regions to accelerate delivery and maintain consistency across their portfolios.

For security integrators and consultants, this creates a unique opportunity to contribute beyond individual projects. Instead of designing one-off solutions, teams can help develop standardized

prototypes for door openings, access control configurations and hardware sets.

These prototypes serve several critical functions: eliminate ambiguity during specification development, reduce variation across multiple sites, streamline coordination between trades, and provide a tested baseline that can be adapted, rather than reinvented.

The Expanding Role of Digital Specification Tools

As projects scale in complexity, digital tools are playing an increasingly important role in how specifications are developed and communicated. Platforms that support collaborative hardware specification and prototyping allow architects, consultants and integrators to work from a shared source of truth.

For integrators, this has several advantages: improved visibility into door hardware and access control requirements, greater alignment with architectural intent, and more accurate system integration planning.

Digital prototyping also enables project teams to validate decisions earlier. Instead of discovering conflicts in the field, teams can resolve them during the design phase, when changes are less costly and easier to implement.

The result is a more coordinated approach that bridges the gap between design and deployment.

Perimeter Security and Exterior Openings

While much of the focus in data center security has traditionally centered on interior access control, there is increased attention being paid to perimeter security and exterior openings.

For integrators and consultants, this includes secure perimeter fencing and controlled gate access, exterior-rated hardware capable of withstanding environmental exposure, and integration of access control systems with outdoor applications.

ZeroEyes Partners with Academic Innovators to Help Universities

https://www.securitysales.com/news/zeroeyes-partners-academic-innovators-universities-security/619289/

ZeroEyes Partners with Academic Innovators to Help Universities

PHILADELPHIA — Multi-analytics weapons detection and threat intelligence platform creator ZeroEyes today announces a new partnership with Academic Innovators, a solutions provider solving the programs, governance, and facilities challenges facing American higher education.

The alliance enables the two companies to combine complementary strengths to help higher education institutions navigate both long-term transformation and immediate safety challenges through a referral program. Academic Innovators' multidisciplinary approach brings together a network of partners and professionals across the higher education ecosystem, including edtech providers, legal experts, financial advisors, investment bankers and public policy specialists, to develop forward-looking solutions for evolving institutional needs.

The industry insiders and strategic collaborators help colleges and universities anticipate change, navigate complexity and proactively shape their future with confidence. By uniting a future-focused advisory approach with ZeroEyes' advanced threat detection and real-time response capabilities, the collaboration empowers institutions to better anticipate threats, enhance preparedness and respond with confidence in an increasingly complex environment.

"We are pleased to partner with ZeroEyes to provide integrated solutions that not only help higher education leaders navigate evolving operational and financial pressures but also enhance campus safety and resilience in an increasingly complex threat landscape," says Dr. Brian C. Mitchell, managing principal and president of Academic Innovators and past president of Washington & Jefferson College and Bucknell University.

ZeroEyes delivers an integrated suite of artificial intelligence-powered analytics and security tools, including capabilities such as weapons detection, real-time threat geolocation and more, designed to enhance preparedness, accelerate threat identification and enable effective response. It provides real-time, actionable intelligence on the illegal brandishing of weapons, such as guns and knives, in or near occupied spaces, alerting local staff and law enforcement with images and precise location data, often in a matter of seconds from the moment a gun is detected.

"By combining our proactive safety technology with Academic Innovators' forward-looking, multidisciplinary expertise, we're helping institutions respond to threats faster and plan more effectively for a safer, more resilient future," says Mike Lahiff, CEO and co-founder of ZeroEyes. "We are proud to partner with them."

How Integrators Help Customers Go from Surveillance to Prevention

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/security-integrators-from-surveillance-to-prevention/619282/

How Integrators Help Customers Go from Surveillance to Prevention

Advancements have created tremendous opportunities for security integrators to deliver smarter and more capable surveillance solutions.

Security integrators have spent the last decade helping customers deploy increasingly sophisticated detection technologies. From artificial intelligence analytics and gun detection to license plate recognition, LiDAR and advanced video analytics, today's security systems can identify threats faster and more accurately than ever.

These advancements have created tremendous opportunities for integrators to deliver smarter and more capable solutions. Yet as detection technology continues to evolve, many end users are asking their integrators a new question: "what happens after the alert?"

The reality is that detection alone does not stop incidents. Detection creates awareness but awareness without action often leaves organizations reacting to events rather than preventing them.

The Shift from Surveillance to Prevention

For many years, physical security systems were designed primarily for forensic purposes. Cameras captured footage, recordings were stored, and evidence could be reviewed after an incident occurred.

Today, many customers want more than evidence. They want solutions that can influence outcomes before an event escalates.

As a result, organizations are increasingly looking to their integrators for guidance on how to bridge the gap between detection and response.

Building Response into Your Surveillance Strategy

Security integrators are helping organizations move beyond standalone devices and toward coordinated response strategies.

Examples include automated notifications and escalation paths, monitoring center integration, live voice communication, automated lighting and visual deterrence, AI-assisted response workflows, and multi-layered security ecosystems.

Rather than relying on a single technology, many organizations are adopting layered security strategies that combine analytics, monitoring, deterrence, communications, and automation into a coordinated response framework.

Designing Security Around Human Behavior

One of the most important conversations taking place in the security industry today has less to do with technology and more to do with human behavior.

Technology plays a critical role in identifying threats, but security professionals are increasingly evaluating how individuals respond to communication, intervention, and deterrence.

For integrators, these conversations represent an opportunity to move beyond equipment recommendations and become strategic advisors. Customers are seeking guidance not only on what technologies to deploy, but also on how those technologies should work together to influence behavior, improve response times, and reduce risk.

The most successful security programs are not necessarily those with the most devices. They are often the programs designed around how people actually behave in real-world situations.

Increasingly, organizations are recognizing that the ultimate goal of security is not simply to document incidents after they occur. It is to prevent them from occurring in the first place.

A New Opportunity for Security Integrators

As organizations shift from surveillance toward prevention, the role of the security integrator continues to expand. Customer expectations are evolving, and integrators have a unique opportunity to help customers build strategies that move beyond awareness and toward prevention.

SIA Welcomes New Chairman of Data Privacy Advisory Board

https://www.securitysales.com/news/sia-tony-manna-chairman-data-privacy-advisory-board/619277/

SIA Welcomes New Chairman of Data Privacy Advisory Board

Tony Manna of Allegion will lead the SIA Data Privacy Advisory Board, an expert group of security industry privacy leaders.

Published: June 9, 2026SSI Staff

The Security Industry Association (SIA) has named Tony Manna as the new chairman of the SIA Data Privacy Advisory Board, according to an association announcement.

The SIA Data Privacy Advisory Board provides information and best practices to help SIA members handle sensitive data in a safe and secure manner to protect the personally identifiable information of their employees, partners and customers from potential abuses, breaches and misuses, the announcement says.

Manna is associate general counsel and deputy chief privacy officer at global security products and solutions provider Allegion, which serves both residential and commercial markets in more than 120 countries. He advises senior leadership and business teams across a broad range of legal matters, supporting strategic initiatives and helping the organization navigate complex legal and regulatory issues.

Manna holds a bachelor's degree, a Juris Doctor and a Master of Science in cybersecurity risk management from Indiana University. He is recognized as a Certified Information Privacy Professional/United States (CIPP/US) and Certified Information Privacy Manager (CIPM) by the International Association of Privacy Professionals.

Why is Manna SIA Data Privacy Advisory Board Chairman?

Manna moderated an SIA Education@ISC conference session on data privacy at ISC West 2026 and hosted a breakout room for the Data Privacy Advisory Board during the 2026 SIA Open House.

Key Data Privacy Advisory Board activities and accomplishments include:

- Developing the Security Cornerstones Learning Series module on data privacy,

- Publishing the SIA Privacy Code of Conduct and data privacy codes of practices for video surveillance and access control to guide the handling of sensitive data and

- Developing the Data Privacy Pro Certificate program, which helps security professionals advance their expertise on key data privacy concepts and gain strategies for data protection and compliance.

"I'm honored to serve as chair of the SIA Data Privacy Advisory Board and to build on the group's strong foundation, including initiatives such as the SIA Data Privacy Pro Certificate," says Manna in the SIA announcement.

Programs like this help security professionals understand evolving privacy and security challenges and apply that knowledge in practical, real-world scenarios to strengthen data protection, he says. As organizations navigate an increasingly complex mix of federal, state and global privacy requirements alongside rapid advances in artificial intelligence and shifting security standards, they need practical, experience-driven guidance.

SIA is proud to welcome Tony Manna as chair of the SIA Data Privacy Advisory Board, says SIA CEO Don Erickson in the association announcement. Tony's deep knowledge of privacy, data protection and risk management and strong leadership experience will provide great value to the advisory board going forward.

We look forward to working with Tony to build on the advisory board's educational content, best practices resources and analysis of the complex privacy, legal and regulatory environment our industry must navigate, he says.

Freddy Kuo, Chairman, Luminys Systems Corp.: Best Advice

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/freddy-kuo-chairman-luminys-best-security-advice/619271/

Freddy Kuo, Chairman, Luminys Systems Corp.: Best Advice

Kuo offers up the best advice he's heard, helps security industry pros on the rise and shines the spotlight on a highly important voice.

Published: June 9, 2026SSI Staff

Our Best Advice Q&A; series creeps closer to a major milestone with Freddy Kuo, chairman of Luminys Systems Corp. and special office executive assistant at Foxlink. He shares the best advice he's ever gotten, gives a tip to security industry newcomers and singles out the person to whom all others should always listen.

Security Sales & Integration: What's the best piece of advice you've ever received?

Freddy Kuo: One of the best pieces of advice I've received is: "Listen to the problem before you present the solution."

That has stayed with me because it is very easy in this industry to lead with technology. We all get excited about the newest capabilities, whether it's better cameras, artificial intelligence analytics, cloud platforms or new integrations.

But, when you sit down with a customer or integrator, the conversation usually becomes more practical very quickly. They are trying to protect people, reduce risk, respond faster and make better decisions. If you start with the product before you understand that reality, you are already moving too fast.

That advice has shaped the way I look at product development and leadership. The best ideas come from understanding what integrators, dealers and end users actually experience in the field. If you understand the problem first, you can build something that is useful in the field, not just impressive in a demo.

SSI: What advice would you give to those looking to achieve success in the security industry?

Kuo: My biggest piece of advice is to learn how the entire security ecosystem works and spend time where the work actually happens.

Success in this industry requires more than knowing cameras, access control or AI. You need to understand how a manufacturer's decision affects a distributor, how that affects an integrator and how

all of it eventually affects the customer using the system every day.

Early in your career, spend time with installers and visit job sites. Talk to customers after deployment, not just during the sales process. Pay attention to what slows projects down, from installation time and network issues to user training, service calls, cybersecurity concerns and long-term support.

If you stay curious, keep learning and never lose touch with the realities customers face every day, you'll make better decisions.

SSI: If you could point to one person in the security industry and tell up-and-comers, "Make sure to listen to what they have to say," whom would you pick and why?

Kuo: I would point to Wayne Hurd, our VP of sales at Luminys. One thing people can learn from Wayne is the importance of staying close to the channel. He spends a lot of time listening to integrators, dealers and partners and he understands the pressure they carry when they recommend a system to a customer.

That has influenced how I think about this industry. A good security solution is shaped by more than what happens in a product meeting. It is shaped by the people who install it, sell it, support it and depend on it after deployment.

The broader lesson is that trust is built slowly. If you want people to believe in what you are building, you have to listen consistently, communicate clearly and understand what they are dealing with after the sale."

Emergency24, Worldview Monitoring Ink Partnership

https://www.securitysales.com/news/emergency24-worldview-monitoring-ink-partnership/619266/

Emergency24, Worldview Monitoring Ink Partnership

The partnership combines Emergency24's monitoring infrastructure and dealer network with Worldview Monitoring's experience in remote guarding.

Published: June 8, 2026SSI Staff

Logo courtesy of Emergency24

DES PLAINES, Ill.– Third-party central station alarm monitoring company Emergency24 has entered into a strategic partnership with Worldview Monitoring focused on "supporting the growing demand for remote guarding services across the United States," according to the joint announcement.

The partnership "combines Emergency24's established monitoring infrastructure and dealer network with Worldview Monitoring's experience in remote guarding delivery," the announcement says.

Together, the companies "aim to help monitoring centers, dealers and security providers introduce and expand remote guarding services in a way that supports long-term growth, recurring revenue opportunities and operational consistency," according to the joint announcement.

Why Are Emergency24 & Worldview Monitoring Partnering?

The partnership between Emergency24 and Worldview Monitoring is “designed to address that need through a service model focused on operational consistency, structured escalation and helping dealers introduce remote guarding in a way that aligns with how they already support commercial customers,” the announcement says.

“Remote guarding has moved well beyond being a niche offering,” says Tim Pearman, CEO of Worldview Monitoring, in the joint announcement. “More dealers and monitoring organizations are actively evaluating how to support it, but maintaining consistency becomes increasingly important as deployments scale.”

“Our partnership with Emergency24 is significant because it validates the model within the U.S. market. The focus is not just on analytics or technology. It’s about delivering the service consistently and helping partners introduce remote guarding in a way that aligns with how they already operate,” he says.

Emergency24 “views the partnership as part of a broader shift taking place across the security industry as video monitoring continues evolving into a more proactive service category,” according to the joint announcement.

“Commercial customers are asking dealers more questions about remote guarding because they want greater visibility and faster intervention when activity occurs after hours,” says Steve Mayer, CEO of Emergency24, in the announcement. “For many dealers, the opportunity now is figuring out how to introduce those services in a way that supports long-term growth while remaining manageable operationally as accounts expand.

“Worldview’s experience in remote guarding delivery made this a strong fit for us. The partnership gives our dealers access to a proven operational model while maintaining the consistency and reliability they expect from Emergency24,” he says.

The partnership “will support monitoring centers, dealers and security providers looking to introduce remote guarding through a structure designed to integrate with existing monitoring environments, dealer workflows and customer relationships,” according to the joint announcement.

Commercial Security Made Easy with Wireless Locks from ProdataKey (PDK)

https://www.securitysales.com/sponsored/commercial-security-made-easy-with-wireless-locks-from-prodatakey-pdk/619261/

Commercial Security Made Easy with Wireless Locks from ProdataKey (PDK)

The Red™ Wireless Cylindrical Lock from ProdataKey represents an intuitive approach to commercial security by delivering easy installation, flexible management, and reliable cloud connectivity.

As demands for smarter, scalable commercial security solutions continue to grow, ProdataKey (PDK) has expanded its portfolio with the introduction of the award-winning Red™ Wireless Cylindrical Lock. Meticulously designed for commercial applications of any size, the Red Cylindrical Lock delivers a streamlined approach to access control that prioritizes ease of use, cost effectiveness, and longevity.

What are the Security Needs of Today’s Commercial Spaces?

From office buildings and educational institutions to healthcare facilities and multi-site enterprises, commercial organizations must balance security, convenience, and operational efficiency. Traditional mechanical locks often lack the flexibility required for modern environments, while hardwired access control solutions can be costly and time-consuming to install.

What Sets the Red Wireless Cylindrical Lock Apart?

The Red Wireless Cylindrical Lock was developed to address these modern security challenges with a streamlined and user-friendly approach. Designed for commercial applications of any size, the lock combines advanced access control capabilities with simplified deployment and management.

One of its most significant advantages is ease of installation. Because the lock communicates wirelessly, organizations can avoid the expense and disruption often associated with running new wiring to doors. This allows facilities to expand access control coverage more quickly and cost-effectively. The solution also provides flexible management through PDK's cloud-based platform, giving administrators the ability to manage access permissions, monitor activity, and make updates remotely.

The Red Cylindrical Lock from ProdataKey represents an intuitive approach to commercial security by delivering easy installation, flexible management, and reliable cloud connectivity. To learn more about how the Red Cylindrical Lock meets the needs of modern commercial environments, visit prodatakey.com/red-wireless-locksets or reach out to sales@prodatakey.com.

Pye-Barker Acquires Washington-Based Fire Protection Specialists

https://www.securitysales.com/news/pye-barker-acquires-fire-protection-specialists/619250/

Pye-Barker Acquires Washington-Based Fire Protection Specialists

Fire Protection Specialists will add integrated fire protection services to Pye-Barker's existing fire alarm and security offerings.

Published: June 8, 2026SSI Staff

Pye-Barker Fire & Safety has acquired Fire Protection Specialists of Liberty Lake, Wash. The deal will add integrated fire protection services to Pye-Barker's existing fire alarm and security offerings in the Pacific Northwest Fire Protection Specialists serves Washington, Oregon, Idaho, Montana and California with advanced system monitoring, system inspections and testing and fire extinguisher service.

ATLANTA — Full-service fire protection, life safety and service service provider Pye-Barker Fire & Safety has acquired Liberty Lake, Wash.-based Fire Protection Specialists, strengthening "its comprehensive services for customers in the Northwest," according to the joint announcement.

This transaction "will add integrated fire protection services to Pye-Barker's existing fire alarm and security offerings in the Pacific Northwest," the announcement says.

Established in 1999, Fire Protection Specialists serves Washington, Oregon, Idaho, Montana and California with the installation and servicing of fire suppression and fire alarm systems for commercial

and industrial customers, including education, utility, government and healthcare facilities.

The company's fire protection solutions include advanced system monitoring, system inspections and testing and fire extinguisher service.

Why Did Pye-Barker Acquire Fire Protection Specialists?

Fire Protection Specialists offers clean agent fire suppression systems to extinguish fire in high value spaces, such as data centers, equipment vaults and MRI/CAT scan rooms. The team also has expertise in automatic extinguishing systems for commercial kitchens and off-road fire suppression systems for heavy mobile equipment.

"We welcome the Fire Protection Specialists team to the Pye-Barker family with open arms," says Bart Proctor, CEO of Pye-Barker, in the joint announcement. "They have a longstanding reputation of expert care in their community, and that legacy was clear in every conversation we had with their team.

"As we join forces, I'm excited for us to strengthen our customer service in Washington and beyond," he says.

Fire Protection Specialists' technicians and staff will continue to serve customers in the Northwest. Nelson Mullins Riley & Scarborough, LLP represented Pye-Barker in the transaction.

Integrators Need to Rethink Their Approach to School Security

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/integrators-need-to-rethink-their-approach-to-school-security/619242/

Integrators Need to Rethink Their Approach to School Security

The discussion about school security is no longer just about cameras, access control systems and emergency response protocols.

Many schools use the summer months to plan for the next academic year, evaluating everything from safety upgrades and infrastructure investments to staffing, budgets and new technology deployments.

One of the most important conversations districts are having right now is around campus safety and security and what it should look like in 2026 and the next academic year. The discussion is no longer just about cameras, access control systems and emergency response protocols.

Schools are also trying to address fights, vandalism, student well-being, unauthorized visitors, behavioral warning signs and growing parent pressure to identify threats before they escalate.

This shift is changing the role security systems integrators are expected to play. Schools are looking beyond hardware and evaluating whether their overall security strategy can help staff identify risk earlier, improve visibility across campus operations and respond faster and smarter to potential incidents.

The good news is that most districts are not starting from scratch. According to the National Center for Education Statistics, nearly 93% of public schools already use security cameras in some capacity. In many cases, they already have extensive infrastructure installed across campuses, sometimes hundreds or thousands of cameras, access control systems and emergency communication tools.

The challenge is: much of this infrastructure still operates reactively, not proactively.

Security teams often need to manually review footage after incidents occur, piece together information across disconnected systems, or rely on staff members to recognize warning signs in real time while managing dozens of other responsibilities. The time and resources behind this add up.

The problem is not visibility. The problem is operational bandwidth.

A district may have hundreds or even thousands of cameras deployed across its campuses, but no school can realistically staff enough people to monitor every feed at all times. As campuses grow larger and schools struggle to staff security teams, many districts are realizing that adding more hardware alone does not necessarily improve situational awareness.

AI Changing What Schools Expect From Security

Artificial intelligence is becoming a larger part of school security conversations and changing what districts expect from their technology partners and integrators. The conversation is becoming less about individual devices and more about how schools actually detect, communicate and respond to potential issues across campus.

For integrators, that changes the discussion entirely. Schools are increasingly asking operational questions like:

- Can technology help identify unusual activity earlier?

- Who receives alerts, and how are they prioritized?

- Can it improve coordination between administrators, school resource officers and security personnel?

- How do these teams respond?

- Can these systems realistically fit into existing workflows?

The answers matter because AI is only valuable if schools can operationalize it effectively. Technology should help staff process information faster and identify patterns that might otherwise go unnoticed, not overwhelm teams with additional complexity or constant false alarms.

Now, districts and decision committees are evaluating how well technology supports the people responsible for keeping campuses safe. Using AI to improve campus safety and security is ultimately a risk management decision, not a technology decision.

Integrators Risk Falling Behind As Schools Move Beyond Hardware

Following major incidents on school campuses over the past several years, many districts invested heavily in emergency response planning and physical security measures. Those investments remain important, but administrators increasingly recognize that many safety incidents are preceded by observable warning signs.

In many cases, staff do not become aware of those situations until students, teachers or administrators report them after the fact. By then, the opportunity for early intervention may be limited and the situation may have already escalated.

As a result, schools are no longer evaluating security systems based solely on cameras, coverage areas or recording capabilities. They are looking for solutions that can help staff identify concerning activity earlier and respond more effectively.

That shift is changing what districts expect from integrators. School leaders want strategic partners who understand deployment, alert management, staffing limitations and how new technologies fit into daily operations — not simply vendors focused on the next hardware upgrade.

Trust and Transparency Matter More Than Ever

One of the biggest mistakes integrators can make right now is overselling what AI can realistically do in a school environment. Administrators are becoming far more educated buyers. They understand that technology should be used to augment human capabilities, not replace them.

FieldResolve Expands Knowledge Base to 40,000+ Documents

https://www.securitysales.com/news/fieldresolve-40000-documents-36-manufacturers/619237/

FieldResolve Expands Knowledge Base to 40,000+ Documents

The CMOOR Group, which focuses on eLearning and compliance solutions for the physical security, fire protection and life safety industries, recently announced its artificial intelligence-powered field support platform, FieldResolve, now houses more than 40,000 documents from 36 manufacturers.

This milestone makes FieldResolve “the most comprehensive technical knowledge base available to security and fire professionals,” according to the CMOOR Group announcement.

With this expansion, projects built inside FieldResolve “can now encompass virtually any security or fire product an integrator or dealer works with, from access control panels and intrusion detection systems to fire alarm controllers, video surveillance equipment and beyond,” the announcement says.

Technicians “can mirror the full, multi-manufacturer complexity of a real installation and get fast, accurate answers across every product on that job,” according to the company announcement.

Real-world security integration is never single-manufacturer, says Connie Moorhead, CEO and founder of The CMOOR Group, in the company announcement. A field technician walks into a job and faces Johnson Controls panels, Bosch detectors, Avigilon cameras and Kidde Commercial fire systems, all in the same building. FieldResolve was built for that reality.

Multi-manufacturer environments are the norm, and among the most challenging scenarios a security technician can face, according to the company announcement. When a system fault occurs, determining whether the problem originates with the panel, a device, the wiring or an integration between two different manufacturers requires deep cross-product troubleshooting knowledge that most technicians carry only through years of experience.

FieldResolve changes that equation. The platform’s technical knowledge base spans products from Honeywell, Bosch, DMP and dozens of additional manufacturers, giving security and fire technicians a single resource that reflects the full scope of what they actually install, the announcement says.

By creating a project in FieldResolve that mirrors an actual installation, including all manufacturers present on the job, technicians can ask questions in plain language and receive precise, sourced answers drawn from that knowledge base, according to the company announcement.

For security and fire integrators managing large, complex installations, including schools, hospitals, high-rise buildings or enterprise campuses, the ability to perform multi-manufacturer troubleshooting from a single platform represents a significant operational advantage, the announcement says. Shorter service call resolution times protect both the customer relationship and the company's bottom line.

FieldResolve is also differentiated by how it handles data, according to the company announcement. All queries and results are end-to-end encrypted, meaning "none of its data ever feeds into the broader large language model (LLM)."

Information entered into FieldResolve remains secure and will never find its way to the internet at large, making it one of the few AI field technician support platforms built with enterprise-grade data privacy at its core, the announcement says.

The 40,000-document, 36-manufacturer milestone "reflects The CMOOR Group's ongoing commitment to building FieldResolve as a true field-ready platform, not a document search tool, but an intelligent technical partner that understands the life safety systems professionals install and service every day," according to the company announcement.

Rescuers Save 8 in Flooded Cave: Surveillance Videos of the Week

https://www.securitysales.com/news/rescuers-save-8-flooded-cave-surveillance-videos-week/619227/

Rescuers Save 8 in Flooded Cave: Surveillance Videos of the Week

Other top surveillance videos this week include sonic booms and meteor explosions across the U.S., a deadly paper mill explosion and more.

Published: June 5, 2026D. Craig MacCormack

Eight cave explorers looking for gold in Laos had to be rescued when the narrow path they were traveling got flooded. That harrowing mission was captured on surveillance video, making it the lead story in the latest edition of Surveillance Videos of the Week.

Other clips this week explore a recent trend by so-called "treasure hunters" in Brooklyn and Queens who were spotted climbing out of sewers in those boroughs, a deadly explosion at a paper mill in Washington that killed 11 people and a fireworks factory explosion in Malta.

One of the biggest stories of the week across the U.S. was the series of sonic booms, meteor explosions and fireballs. As you might imagine, those rare occurrences made for some spectacular videos!

Click here to check out the latest batch of Surveillance Videos of the Week. Send your suggestions for future editions to digital editor Craig MacCormack at craig.maccormack@emeraldx.com.

Posted In: News

The Monitoring Association Elects 2026-2028 Board of Directors

https://www.securitysales.com/news/the-monitoring-association-elects-2026-2028-board-of-directors/619224/

The Monitoring Association Elects 2026-2028 Board of Directors

The Monitoring Association (TMA) board members bring expertise from across the professional monitoring, security and technology sectors.

Published: June 5, 2026SSI Staff

McLEAN, Va. — The Monitoring Association (TMA) today announces the election of seven industry leaders to serve on its board of directors for the 2026–2028 term.

The directors will begin their terms following the association's Annual Meeting in November 2026.

The following individuals were re-elected to the TMA board of directors:

- Michael Picciola, ADT, LLC – Vice President

- Justin Bailey, Becklar Monitoring – Secretary

- David Charney, Everon – At-Large Board Member

- Richard Flores, Puget Sound Energy – GSOC Board Member

- Brandon Niles, Acadian Monitoring Services, LLC – Contract Monitoring Board Member

- Joseph Pereira, Securitas Technology – At-Large Board Member

- Joey Rao-Russell, Kimberlite Corporation dba Sonitrol – Regional Board Member

What Does TMA Leadership Say About the Board?

TMA is fortunate to benefit from the expertise, vision, and commitment of these accomplished industry leaders, says TMA president Alan Gillmore IV in the association announcement. Their collective experience in professional monitoring, security and technology will help guide the association as it advances initiatives that strengthen the professional monitoring industry and support our members.

As members of the board of directors, the elected leaders will help shape the association's strategic direction and oversee programs that advance public safety, industry standards, education, advocacy and innovation throughout the monitoring and security sectors, according to the TMA announcement.

SIA Appoints Jasvir Gill as Vice Chairman of Utilities Advisory Board

https://www.securitysales.com/news/sia-jasvir-gill-vice-chairman-utilities-advisory-board/619216/

SIA Appoints Jasvir Gill as Vice Chairman of Utilities Advisory Board

Gill will join SIA Utilities Advisory Board chairman Joey St. Jacques in leading the expert group of utility security thought leaders.

Published: June 4, 2026SSI Staff

The Security Industry Association (SIA) has named Dr. Jasvir Gill as the new vice chairman of the SIA Utilities Advisory Board, which "demonstrates thought leadership on compliance and technology topics of interest to professionals managing security at utility facilities."

Gill is founder and CEO of Alert Enterprise and he has spent more than two decades advancing enterprise security through artificial intelligence-driven automation and identity-first security strategies. In recognition of his contributions to engineering, technology and industry leadership, Gill was awarded an honorary doctorate of engineering by Guru Nanak Dev University in 2026.

Prior to founding Alert Enterprise, he founded Virsa Systems, a governance, risk and compliance and application security company acquired by SAP in 2006. Beyond business, Gill supports industry and community initiatives, including serving on advisory boards and leading Trakki, his initiative focused on education, AI learning and community development in Punjab, India.

When the SIA Utilities Advisory Board was established in 2022, Gill was among the group's founding members and immediately stepped into the role of Technology Subcommittee chairman. He has been "engaged with the advisory board's development of educational content to help utility security practitioners, integrators and end users tackle cyber-physical convergence in practical, actionable terms," according to the SIA announcement.

"Critical infrastructure is the backbone of modern society, and securing it is one of the defining challenges of our time. I am honored to serve as vice chair of the SIA Utilities Advisory Board and collaborate with some of the brightest minds in our industry to advance the future of cyber-physical security," says Gill in the announcement.

"We have an extraordinary opportunity to reimagine security as a catalyst for resilience, operational excellence and sustainable growth," he says. "By bringing together innovation, leadership and a shared commitment to protecting what matters most, we can help build a safer, stronger and more connected world."

SIA is proud to welcome Dr. Jasvir Gill as vice chair of the SIA Utilities Advisory Board, says SIA CEO Don Erickson in the association announcement. Since this group was established, Jasvir has brought his conviction, passion and expertise to helping address the unique security challenges facing utilities.

His leadership in partnership with chair Joey St. Jacques will be immensely valuable in the advisory board's efforts to shape how the next generation of security professionals approaches the protection of critical infrastructure, says Erickson.

The SIA Utilities Advisory Board develops recommendations and guidance for the physical security and cybersecurity of utilities infrastructure, offers formal responses to security rules and guidance proposed by regulatory agencies, shares knowledge with related industries and develops content for SIA events and publications.

Key advisory board initiatives include helping to develop the Security Cornerstones module on critical infrastructure security, hosting the annual Protecting Utilities lunch events at ISC West and East, developing a six-session SIAacademy LIVE! course on securing utilities and the energy sector and developing SIA's Guide to NERC CIP Compliance.

How to Find Integration Partners Who Will Drive Long-Term Growth

https://www.securitysales.com/insights/how-to-find-integration-partners-drive-long-term-growth/619211/

How to Find Integration Partners Who Will Drive Long-Term Growth

Due diligence with integration partners can catalyze your growth through marketing streams, increased market exposure and proven excellence.

Security integrators often invest significant effort engaging with technology providers or manufacturers that fail to deliver what customers actually need. In the worst cases, so-called “partners” actively hurt the integrator’s business or deliver short-sighted solutions that don’t contribute to an optimal security posture.

The good news is that great partnerships are possible — and due diligence in partnership coordination can catalyze your growth through new marketing streams, increased market exposure and proven excellence in your craft.

To help you avoid poor partnerships and effectively deliver on your customers’ needs, let’s explore the realities of partner development today, red flags you should look for, and proven ways to transform your partner strategy into a long-term growth advantage.

Customers increasingly need integrators to bring more than piecemeal solutions to the table. The security market is flooded with vendors and focused capabilities, but every investment must support a holistic, programmatic solution that efficiently meets the stated goals.

Some solution providers may appear to be a perfect fit for your customers’ current need, however, these relationships can quickly introduce reputational risk or simply be unable to generate ongoing customer value.

The most effective partnerships are built on established rules of engagement, joint sales motions, long-term commitment, and open collaboration with industry players.

These guiding principles will help you define what you are seeking in prospective partners. Next is strengthening your ability to evaluate partners for alignment with those principles.

Thorough vetting of any potential partner can reduce the risk of false starts or building a network of frenemies who don’t have your best interest in mind.

There are several red flags to look for when deciding whether a vendor is trustworthy to partner with, exemplifies a commitment to preserving your customer experience, and will ultimately support your brand’s reputation and growth.

Ask questions like these throughout your discovery and evaluation process to develop the greatest likelihood of a fulfilling partnership:

- “How does your direct sales program support partner relationships?”

- “What joint marketing opportunities do you hope to engage in?”

- “Do you have a tiered partner program, or how do you incentivize partners that bring more business to you?”

- “How quickly can you respond to support needs and how do you assist us with product or service concerns?”

By following these guidelines, you can find integration partners who will drive long-term growth for your business.

Wf-vision

Sunbrella Introduces Marx Outdoor Drapery

https://www.wf-vision.com/industry-news/sunbrella-introduces-marx-outdoor-drapery/

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Outdoor spaces have become an extension of the home, and soft furnishings are helping create environments that feel more comfortable, inviting and refined. Sunbrella has introduced Marx Outdoor Drapery, which is designed to provide a stylish and functional solution for outdoor living spaces.

Sombra Shades Expands U.S. Presence with New Headquarters, Warehouse and Technology Training Facility in Texas

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Sombra Shades Expands U.S. Presence with New Headquarters, Warehouse and Technology Training Facility in Texas

Sombra Shades has expanded its U.S. presence with a new headquarters, warehouse, and technology training facility in Texas. The company's growth is a testament to the demand for high-quality window treatments in the region.

The new facility will enable Sombra Shades to better serve its customers in the U.S., providing them with faster delivery times and more efficient service. The company's commitment to innovation and customer satisfaction has been recognized through various industry awards and certifications.

Sombra Shades' expansion into Texas is a significant milestone for the company, marking a major step forward in its growth strategy. With this new facility, Sombra Shades is well-positioned to continue meeting the increasing demand for its products in the U.S. market.

From Shade to Sustainability: Inside Yardzen's 2026 Trend Report

https://www.wf-vision.com/outdoor-living/from-shade-to-sustainability-inside-yardzens-2026-trend-report/

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Outdoor living continues to evolve as homeowners seek to create spaces that are not only beautiful but also sustainable. One key trend in outdoor living is the integration of technology and nature. This can be seen in the use of smart home devices, solar panels, and rainwater harvesting systems.

From Shade to Sustainability: Inside Yardzen’s 2026 Trend Report

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Yardzen's 2026 Trend Report highlights the importance of sustainability in outdoor design. The report notes that homeowners are increasingly looking for ways to reduce their environmental impact while still enjoying their outdoor spaces. This includes using eco-friendly materials, reducing water consumption, and incorporating green roofs and walls into their designs.

The trend towards sustainability is not limited to just the design itself but also extends to the way people interact with their outdoor spaces. Homeowners are increasingly looking for ways to create spaces that promote relaxation, entertainment, and socialization while also being mindful of the environment.

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Hartmann&Forbes; Named One of Oregon's Best Green Workplaces

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Hartmann&Forbes; Named One of Oregon’s Best Green Workplaces

Luxury window and wall covering manufacturer Hartmann&Forbes; has once again been recognized by Oregon Business Magazine as one of the state’s 100 Best Green Workplaces.